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翻译实践报告

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A Report on the Translation of *The Business of Indie Games: Everything You Need to Know to Conquer the Indie Games Industry* (Chapters 5-6)

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翻译实践报告

摘 要

本翻译实践报告的文本选自《独立游戏业征服者指南》(*The Business of Indie Games: Everything You Need to Know to Conquer the Indie Games Industry*) 中的第 5-6 章。该书内容主要涉及独立游戏业, 翻译该书是希望为中国游戏业的发展引入新的观点和视角, 从而提升中国在独立游戏业的竞争力, 促进中国文化的输出。

该书为实用型书籍, 其中代词使用频次极高, 译者需要判定代词的功能之后, 再根据中文语境准确传递原文的意思; 因本书涉及专业领域, 故而存在大量专业术语, 译者需要扩展知识储备以便更好地翻译术语; 文中存在诸多结构复杂且包含多个从句的句式, 因此译者需要厘清各部分之间的逻辑, 了解作者的真实意图之后, 再用便于受众群体理解的方式传达作者的意图。

因此, 在目的论的指导下, 本报告对原文中的代词、术语、复合句进行了细致分析, 在翻译过程中采用省译、重组、转译等翻译技巧对原文进行合理的处理, 以求减少中英文之间的文化差异, 消除受众群体在阅读中的障碍, 准确传达作者的表达意图, 确保译文符合目标受众群体的认知水平, 从而确保受众群体对原文内容的接受度。此外, 通过对文本的翻译, 本实践报告还总结了不同情况下代词、术语以及复合句适用的翻译方法。

关键词: 目的论; 代词; 术语; 复合句

**A Report on the Translation of *The Business of Indie Games:*
Everything You Need to Know to Conquer the Indie Games Industry
(Chapters 5-6)**

Abstract

The source text of this report is excerpted from Chapters 5-6 of *The Business of Indie Games: Everything You Need to Know to Conquer the Indie Games Industry*. This book mainly explores the indie game industry, and the purpose of this translation project is designed to add some new ideas and perspectives to China's game industry. China's competitiveness in the indie game industry can be significantly improved and more Chinese culture can be exported to the rest of the world.

As a practical book, where pronouns are used extensively, it should be accurately translated after the translator identifies the functions of pronouns and adapts their meaning to the Chinese context. Exploring a professional field, *The Business of Indie Games* contains a large number of terminology, which requires the translator to expand the horizon to smooth translation. Some sentences with complex structures and multiple clauses are commonly seen in this book, so the inner logic of each part should be clarified to make sure the actual purpose of the author is expressed to targeted audience in an acceptable way.

Thus, under the guidance of Skopos Theory, this report analyzes pronouns, terminology and compound sentences in detail. In the course of translation, omission, restructuring and conversion are properly adopted to translate the source text, so as to reduce the cultural differences between Chinese and English and eliminate obstacles for the targeted audience. By doing so, the true intention of the author can be exactly presented to the audience, whose acceptance of the source text can be ensured as well through making the translation fit their cognition. In addition, the translator summarizes appropriate translation methods for pronouns, terminology and

compound sentences in different situations after accomplishing this translation project.

Key words: Skopos Theory; pronouns; terminology; compound sentences

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Chapter 1 Introduction

The present chapter is designed to provide a brief overview of this project, including the following three parts: first, in the component of the Background of the Project, it is put under discussion the reason why the book is chosen by the translator, main features of the source text and the theory guiding this project; second, the Significance of the Project will be further demonstrated respectively from the perspectives of the chosen book, the translation project and the guidance of the theory; last but not least, the Structure of the Project will present the topic discussed in each chapter.

1.1 Background

The game industry has developed vigorously, which can promote strong growth of economy and culture. Games are not only a means of entertainment but also an expression of culture and national spirit. Admittedly, games have become a medium of cultural output. A world-famous game can export its culture to global players. Blessed with a long history and profound culture, China, however, has just few world-class representative games due to the lack of systematic and scientific game production methods. *The Business of Indie Games: Everything You Need to Know to Conquer the Indie Games Industry* demonstrates practical ideas about how to make a successful indie game. By learning from the advanced experience of others, the Chinese game industry can improve its production expertise, promote its overall development, spread Chinese culture and tell China's stories to the world.

The source text is excerpted from a practical book about indie games. Profound insights into the game industry presented by the three authors, all senior game practitioners, can be found in this book. This report will be based on the analysis of the translation text of Chapters 5-6 excerpted from *The Business of Indie Games*. These two chapters belong to Part Two “*Pre-Development Choices*”, which can help indies to better know the implications of almost every possible choice during the

planning phase of indie game production and to make their indie games launch successfully. As this book refers to the game industry, a fairly professional field, its linguistic features can be clearly divided into three types: terminology regarding the game industry, abundant use of pronouns and compound sentences with complex structures and multiple clauses.

Thus, in the course of translating the source text from English into Chinese, the characteristics of the two languages need to be taken into account to fit the expression of the target language, and to facilitate the understanding of Chinese native speakers. To this end, Hans Vermeer's Skopos Theory is adopted as a guiding theory in this project. This theory emphasizes that the translation serves readers, and that translation is a purpose-oriented activity. During the process of translation, all relative factors of the audience need to be considered, making sure that translation is properly handled so that readers can better understand the content.

1.2Significance

This book mainly explores the indie game industry, demonstrating what steps should be taken by indie game developers during each stage of making a game to ensure a successful indie game. Some new ideas and perspectives containing professional suggestions and practical measures presented in this book can give impetus to the development of China's game industry, as well as to the improvement of Chinese game developers and the people who are interested in making games.

On the one hand, this translation project can provide valuable lessons on how to make a successful indie game for Chinese developers, and help them hone their skills to produce world-class games, thus promoting the cultural output of China and enhancing China's status in the international community. On the other hand, it can facilitate the growth of localized translation in the game industry. As translators should take targeted group into consideration while conducting translation, appropriate translation strategies and methods need to be applied to guarantee that the translation will be suitable for the expression of the target language. Therefore, fulfilling this translation project can promote the improvement of localized translation

in terms of the game industry.

The source text excerpted from *The Business of Indie Games* falls into a professional field, so pronouns, terminology, and compound sentences in the text could be the difficulties in the course of translating the English source text into Chinese. According to Hans Vermeer's Skopos Theory, the translation needs to serve the audience, and the language expression needs to fit their cognition so that the audience can understand the translation as much as possible, so as to facilitate their better understanding. Under the guidance of such a theory, appropriate translation skills adopted in this project can be better applied to solve the difficulties above.

1.3Structure

The topic discussed in each chapter is as follows:

Chapter 1 gives a brief introduction to this translation project, covering the background, significance, and structure of the project, showing the purpose and main logic of this project. Chapter 2 explores the features of the source text, analyzing the main content of the source text and its linguistic features, including lexical and syntactic features, to better prepare the translator for this translation project. Chapter 3 demonstrates Skopos Theory guiding the process of translation, introducing its three basic rules, its relevant studies, and its applicability to the project. In Chapter 4, the author illustrates the difficulties confronted during translation, covering pronouns, terminology and compound sentences, and gives some examples to account for how the translator overcomes these obstacles under the guidance of Skopos Theory with specific translation skills. Chapter 5 concludes the general translation methods used in different situations of translating pronouns, terminology and compound sentences, which are drawn on the experience of this translation project, as well as how to improve the capacity to work out the unsolved problems in this project.

Chapter 2 Analysis of the Source Text

While the previous chapter offers a general picture of this project, this chapter is focused more on the source text, analyzing its main content in the first part, so as to illustrate the significance of the project. The analysis of the linguistic features of the source text from the perspectives of lexis and sentence in the second part, clearly demonstrated by concrete examples of the source text, is aimed at better preparing the translator for this project.

2.1 Main Content

Co-written by Alex Josef, Alex Van Lepp, and Marshall D. Carper, *The Business of Indie Games: Everything You Need to Know to Conquer the Indie Games Industry* is a practical book about indie games. Profound insights into the game industry presented by the three authors, all senior game practitioners, can be found in this book. Containing fifteen chapters, from an introduction to the current indie game industry, different choices in the game production process, how to make a successful launch, to what to do after launching indie games, this book is divided into five parts, namely Part One “*How the Indie Game Industry Works*”, Part Two “*Pre-Development Choices*”, Part Three “*Pitches and Publishing Deals*”, Part Four “*The Road to Release*” and Part Five “*Post-Release*”, within which Chapters 5-6 belong to Part Two “*Pre-Development Choices*”. Chapter Five “*Project Types and Project Goals*” and Chapter Six “*Genre and Market Evaluation*” give a specific picture of how to do the right choices during the planning phase of indie game production so as to help indie game developers to better know the implications of almost every possible choice in this phase.

Divided into two parts, Chapter Five mainly explores pre-development choices and how to choose the right path to publish a game successfully. In the first part, the pre-development overview is provided, making indie game developers know the importance of choices to their projects, and a step-by-step guide is given to help game

makers to apply this section to their true pre-development. Then, the definitions of various types of projects are given to assist indie game developers to define their own projects, and examples of successful indie games are used to demonstrate how the right path pushes forward the game to be successful in the second part. Thus, reading these two sections will benefit indie game makers to find the right way to launch their games.

Chapter Six includes two parts: “*Predicting Sales Success*” and “*Stepping Back for the Big Picture*”, clearly showing what indie game developers in the development phase need to do for pushing a successful launch. In this chapter, the access to sales of a game is listed for indie game developers to ensure that they can make accurate sales projections for their own game based on the performances of comparable titles and that they can tap into the trend of the industry to expand their profits. After having made a series of well-tempered choices, indie game developers need to review and adjust their plans in accordance with the latest developments, so as to make sure the plan is in the right direction for a successful launch.

2.2 Linguistic Features

Knowing the main features of the source text serves as the key step for a higher quality translation, helping the translator capture the expression habits of the author, define the main difficulties of the source text, and determine which theory to be applied during the process of translation. Thus, the translator can improve capacities to adapt to the source text and search for more information about the field referred to in the book to expand horizons for a better understanding of the author’s purpose.

2.2.1 Lexical Features

To better accomplish the translation project, the translator should conduct a thorough research about lexical features of the source text, which means grasping the author’s expression habit with respect to words. In such a source text, lexical features mainly include extensive use of pronouns and terminology in terms of the game industry.

A. Pronouns

Different from Chinese, English is a language with a preference for pronouns, commonly put in front of nouns to modify them or used to refer to nouns, infinitive phrases and so on. But in some situations, pronouns do not serve the two functions mentioned before. Therefore, in the course of translation, the translator needs to determine the true function of pronouns and send the true meaning to the targeted group.

Example 1:

Source text: **These** exercises, for as abstract as **they** might feel, can prevent many of the most common project-killing problems for indie developers.

Example 2:

Source text: Publishers can tell when a pitch deck was made the night before or if a budget is based on imaginary numbers, so **it** says a lot about an indie to see that **they** are putting significant effort into planning from the beginning.

In the examples mentioned above, we can see pronouns abounding in English, mainly fulfilling their grammatical functions. In Example 1, the pronoun “these” is aimed to modify the noun “exercises”, and the pronoun “they” refers to the aforementioned noun phrase “these exercises”; in Example 2 the pronoun “it” refers to the subsequent infinitive phrase “to see”.

The key point, during translation, is to determine the real function of pronouns in the sentence and think about whether they are necessary to be translated into Chinese. As Chinese belongs to parataxis, on some occasions, pronouns should be omitted to fit Chinese expression habits (叶子南, 2008). To bridge the gap between targeted audience and the actual purpose expressed by the author, the translator should focus more on this difference to get an accurate expression.

B. Terminology

The Business of Indie Games: Everything You Need to Know to Conquer the Indie Games Industry is a practical book, referring to a highly professional field, so terminology belonging to the indie industry is commonly seen in the source text of Chapters 5-6. That means the abilities of the translator need to be improved to acquaint her with the terminology and the knowledge of the translator should be

accumulated through searching for more information to better understand the indie industry.

Example 3:

Source text: Hobby projects – **Game jams** or small side projects that might have commercial value but are really more about learning and experimentation

Example 4:

Source text: Even if the developers execute on their initial concept, the art is usually janky and the **controls** are a bit wonky, but making a commercial game isn't the point.

Numerous terminology related to the indie industry can be found in the source text, such as the terminology “game jams” (限时游戏开发活动) in Example 3 and “controls” (操作感) in Example 4.

Terminology can be an obstacle for the translator to understand the actual purpose of the author, which requires the translator to conduct a huge amount of information search to better comprehend the indie industry. After that, the translator should use appropriate Chinese to present the meaning in an acceptable way to targeted audience.

2.2.2 Syntactic Features

Although the words used in the source text are not complicated and are relatively concise, varied sentences containing multiple clauses and complicated structures are commonly seen in Chapters 5-6. Comprehending the structure of sentences will facilitate the translation text to be more acceptable and accurate for targeted readers.

Example 5:

Source text: In cases where it is impractical to turn back, like a year of development in a particular engine, the ideas we explore in this section can help illuminate potential opportunities that may have been otherwise hidden.

Example 6:

Source text: While we can learn a lot from how they approached crowdfunding, many of our readers are unlikely to have the resources and clout that Sabotage Studios had at the beginning of their campaign.

These two examples above well demonstrate the sentence features contained in the source text, where multiple clauses can be seen. In Example 5, there are three attributive clauses respectively modifying the antecedents “cases”, “ideas” and “opportunities”. In Example 6, an object clause following “a lot from” and an attributive clause modifying “the resources and clout” can be clearly seen.

In sum, the ability to analyze compound sentences should be based on a strong cognition of grammar for a better comprehension of the inner logic of the sentence. Apart from that, the translator should master linguistic differences between Chinese and English, as Chinese focuses on parataxis while English stresses on hypotactic, so it is necessary for the translator to strengthen the capacity of Chinese expression to find the best way to pass the message contained in the compound sentences to targeted audience in an appropriate way to help them get a better understanding (连淑能, 1993).

Chapter 3 Theoretical Basis: Skopos Theory

The main content and linguistic features of the source text have been analyzed in the previous chapter, providing a general picture for the translator to basically know main difficulties that may be encountered during the course of the translation, including pronouns, terminology and compound sentences. This chapter covers three parts: a brief introduction to Skopos Theory, containing three rules which will be further explored respectively; relevant studies of Skopos Theory to facilitate the translator to get a better comprehension of this theory so as to be well prepared for the translation project; and the applicability of Skopos theory, which will demonstrate the ideas about how to apply this theory to the translation project.

3.1 An Overview of Skopos Theory

The main content of the source text is about the indie industry, a fairly professional field, which is targeted at indie game makers. That means the translation is designed to facilitate the understanding of targeted audience, matching the purpose of Hans Vermeer's Skopos Theory. This theory emphasizes that the translation serves readers, and that translation is a purposeful activity (卢祖璜, 2010). In this process, all relative factors of the audience need to be considered, making sure that translation is properly handled so that readers can better understand the content. Skopos Theory includes three rules, namely Skopos Rule, Coherence Rule, and Fidelity Rule. That means translation should adhere to all these rules to fulfill the purpose of making the translation text accepted by the targeted readers.

A. Skopos Rule

The translation is a piece of work to bring the message expressed in one language to another language, so the expression of translation depends on the purpose of the message. Skopos Rule is the most crucial one of these three principles of Skopos Theory, just as Vermeer and Reiss (2013) put it : “The highest rule of a theory of translational action is the ‘skopos rule’: any action is determined by its purpose, i.e.

it is a function of its purpose of skopos” (p. 90). The main purpose of translation is to serve readers, so during the translation, the translator should not only focus on translating the source text, conveying the meaning to targeted audience, but also consider the acceptance of the targeted readers, using more suitable and understandable expressions in accordance with their expectation, so as to facilitate their comprehension and absorption of the message.

B. Coherence Rule

Coherence Rule requires that the translation should adhere to intratextual coherence, that is to say, the translation should be readable and acceptable (Reiss & Vermeer, 1984). In the course of translation, the translator should pay attention to moderately comprehending the context to ensure the inner logic is consistent, in order to accurately express the purpose of the author. At the same time, the cognitive capacity of targeted audience should be taken into account. When there are cultural differences between the source language and the target language, the translator should remove the barriers for the readers, to help them better absorb the message conveyed by the author. Under the guidance of Coherence Rule, the translation can be polished to be closer to the expression of the target language, which makes it easier for the targeted group to understand the message.

C. Fidelity Rule

Fidelity Rule is confined by Skopos Rule and Coherence Rule, referring to an adherence to intertextual coherence, which means the coherence between the source text and the translation text (卞建华, 2008). According to Nord (1991), the degree and form of faithfulness depend on the purpose of the translation and the translator's comprehension of the source text. So to guarantee the fidelity of translation, the translator is required to master relevant knowledge of the field mentioned in the source text to improve the comprehension of the message. Meanwhile, the meaning conveyed by the translated text to targeted audience should be the same as the source text, which requires that the translator should be faithful to the source text and avoid adding or omitting content at will in the translated text, so as to ensure the message

that readers receive is the original meaning of the author.

3.2 Applicability of Skopos Theory in Guiding Translation

From the linguistic features of the source text analyzed in Chapter 2, such difficulties can be found in the translation of the source text as pronouns, terminology, and compound sentences. The source text is targeted at Chinese indie game developers, so during the process of translation, the translator should consider various elements, such as the background, knowledge base and cognitive level, of targeted audience to facilitate their better understanding of the message conveyed by the author, so as to fulfill the purpose of the source text. To this end, under the guidance of Skopos Theory, whose core concept perfectly matches the purpose of this project, the translator can find appropriate translation methods to solve difficulties in translation.

The source text excerpted from *The Business of Indie Games* mainly explores how to make the right choices in the development process to push forward a successful game launch. Chinese indie game makers want to get some specific and practical steps and measures to be applied in their true development phase after reading this section. In this spirit, Skopos Rule can help the translator to think more about whether the Chinese expression is understood by targeted audience, especially some professional expression in the source text, and whether it is viable for the indie game developers to accept and apply the content to the true circumstance according to the reality of the Chinese indie industry. Thus, under the guidance of Skopos Rule, the translator can better find proper expressions in Chinese to realize the purpose of the author and to promote the content better applied by the game developers when they are making a game.

Based on the fulfillment of Skopos Rule, the translator, in the translation process, should also consider the cultural differences between the Chinese indie industry and that of western countries. The translation text directly presented according to the mindset of English may not be accepted by Chinese game developers, so the translator

should search for more information about the Chinese indie industry, such as published Chinese books related to indie games and relevant articles reporting indie games involved in *The Business of Indie Games*, to better know what expression can be well accepted by the targeted readers. By doing so, the translation text, under the guidance of Coherence Rule of Skopos Theory, can be polished by removing cultural barriers in the message to facilitate game developers' understanding. Therefore, the translation text can be more readable and acceptable for targeted audience, so as to promote their absorption of the message expressed by the author.

Fidelity Rule can be conducted to ensure the translation text is faithful to the content of the source text, which means translating the real and even deep meaning of the content instead of the superficial meaning of the words. The source text is about the indie industry, definitely containing something unique about this industry, so under this circumstance, the translator should be really aware of what the author wants to convey, and ensure the expression can be well accepted by Chinese indie game makers. Under the guidance of Fidelity Rule, the meaning and purpose of the author can be exactly presented to the targeted readers without adding any content irrelevant to the text or leaving out any necessary information of the source text.

Chapter 4 Translation Difficulties and Core Solutions

The previous chapter explored the guiding theory of this project and explained how to apply Skopos Theory to the translation. Chapter 4 will present specific case analyses, including two parts: difficulties in the process of translation and translation under the guidance of Skopos Theory. The former one introduces the main obstacles in the source text respectively, which covers pronouns, terminology, and compound sentences; and the latter one illustrates how to solve these difficulties with the application of Skopos Theory and effective translation methods to fulfill the purpose of this project.

4.1 Translation Difficulties

The source text mainly illustrates the professional know-how of the indie industry to help indie game developers to make a successful game, which inevitably contains specialized expressions and words belonging to this industry. At this level, pronouns and terminology might be difficulties for the translator when trying to get the accurate meaning of the author. Compound sentences, consisting of multiple clauses, are frequently used in the source text, which requires the translator should have a solid foundation of grammar knowledge to identify the inner logic of the sentences. Thus, pronouns, terminology and compound sentences are the main obstacles during the translation.

4.1.1 Pronouns

Pronouns are commonly seen in English, with different functions such as serving as subject or object, modifying nouns, as well as referring to the aforementioned nouns and subsequent infinitive phrases. But the situation in Chinese is different, so there are several other key factors to be considered in the course of translation in addition to grammar.

Example 7:

Source text: How to Use **This** Section for True Pre-Development

Target text: 如何在实际预开发阶段中运用本章节的内容

Example 8:

Source text: Changing the scope of **your** game or opting to expand **your** team also triggers follow-up considerations.

Target text: 改变游戏规模，或选择扩大团队，也都会引起后续事项的变动。

Although the pronouns in the examples above are all used to modify nouns, the considerations are not completely the same. In Example 7, as the pronoun “this” carries an important meaning describing the following content, it needs to be retained in Chinese to completely pass the content expressed by the author to targeted audience, but the translator should consider the appropriate meaning to make it adapt to the Chinese context. In Example 8, both meaning of the pronoun “your” can be expressed by the modified nouns “game” and “team” in Chinese, as throughout the whole passage the content is targeted to the indie game developers so there is no need to emphasize the main target in the Chinese condition. Thus, omitting the pronouns and just translating nouns modified by them is enough.

Generally speaking, Chinese is such a concise language, which avoids repeating content and reduces the redundancy of the text. For this reason, when translating pronouns, the translator should first recognize their function, and then consider the differences between Chinese and English to get the most appropriate and accurate expression. To solve the former, the translator just needs a solid foundation of grammar, but the latter requires a higher level of expression capacity in Chinese so that the translator can be aware of whether pronouns should be retained or omitted.

4.1.2 Terminology

According to Fang (2011), terminology refers to specialized terms of various disciplines, which are used to correctly mark things, phenomena and processes in different specialized fields. Terminology in the source text refers to words and phrases carried the specialized meanings of the indie industry where relevant information about this industry should be taken into account to acquire the message conveyed by the author.

Example 9:

Source text: **Early Access** projects – These titles could ultimately be self-published or released in partnership with a publisher, but the development includes leveraging Steam’s **Early Access** community.

Target text: 抢先体验项目：这些游戏最终可以由个人发行或与发行商合作发行，但其开发过程需要利用 Steam 抢先体验社区。

Example 10:

Source text: How choosing an art style impacts development and **pitching**

Target text: 游戏美术风格的选择影响游戏开发和推介的方式

The word “Early Access” in Example 9 is terminology whose meaning cannot be found in the dictionary, so the translator should take advantage of the context, in which the author tries to describe a behavior before formally launching a game developers put the game into the market to let game players experience how brilliant the game is and collect relevant comments to facilitate the subsequent adjustment, and search for information about the Steam platform to find a proper expression of this word which is ultimately translated as “抢先体验”, an earlier game experience provided by Steam. In Example 10, the meaning of “pitching” explained in the dictionary does not fit the context, which requires the translator to broaden the horizon to find out its actual meaning in the game industry, where pitch events for game developers to promote their game to attract investment are found. Therefore, the word “pitching” can be perfectly described by the Chinese words “推介”.

When the basic definition of each word or phrase is not suitable for the context or cannot express the purpose of the author, the translator must know it is used to express something specialized, phenomenon and process, hence it can be seen as terminology. In this case, the translator should make full use of the context to get a general meaning of the terminology, make every possible effort to search for relevant information according to the key words presented in the sentence, and finally summarize the materials got in hand to work out an acceptable expression to fulfill the purpose of the author.

4.1.3 Compound Sentences

In the English language, a compound sentence is made up of at least two

independent clauses that are joined by a conjunction, and these two clauses are divided into a main clause and a subordinate clause. Compound sentences with multiple clauses can be frequently seen in the source text. The key point in the course of translation is not only to identify the types of subordinate clauses but also to better know the inner logic of the sentence and adjust the structure to the expression habits of Chinese.

Example 11:

Source text: If you are at this stage in your indie journey where you haven't actually started making your game, or are very early, this section will give you a step-by-step guide for a thorough indie game planning process.

Target text: 如果独立游戏之旅还未进入正式制作游戏的阶段,或处于游戏制作初期,那么本节将逐步指导读者制定详尽的独立游戏规划。

Example 12:

Source text: Each choice in the development process ripples into the others, and while you can't anticipate every possible decision you will have to make as an indie, our hope is that this book helps you anticipate the options that many indies overlook.

Target text: 同样,开发过程中的每一次选择也会对其他方面产生涟漪效应。尽管独立游戏制作人无法预测到可能出现的每一个选择,但本书希望能帮助读者窥见多数独立游戏制作人所忽视的选择。

In Example 11, the main structure of the sentence is an adverbial clause of condition, which contains an attributive clause modifying “at this stage”, so the translator should adhere to expression habits of attributive in Chinese to restructure the sentence. In Example 12, more clauses can be found, especially the predicative clause following “our hope is that”, which needs to be converted into an object clause to fit the Chinese context.

The inner logic of compound sentences can be easily understood as long as the translator has a strong foundation of grammar, but the translation text needs to be polished to fit the Chinese context according to the differences between Chinese and English. After acquiring the actual meaning of the sentences, in order to express them concisely and correctly, the translator should apply various translation methods to

make sure the translation fits the Chinese expressions.

4.2 Corresponding Solutions to Difficulties

In order to solve the difficulties mentioned above, Skopos Theory plays an important part in the course of translation, which ensures that the translator focuses more on targeted audience to improve their acceptance of the translation text and to guarantee that the purpose of the project is fulfilled. Under the guidance of Skopos Theory, the translator, during the process of translating pronouns, terminology and compound sentences, can better recognize the cultural barriers between Chinese and English, and find out proper ways to accurately present the meaning expressed by the author to targeted audience.

4.2.1 Omission and Revivification

The functions of pronouns are easy to be identified in the sentences, but it is hard for the translator to make the translation fit the Chinese context, which will be accomplished with the guidance of Skopos Theory. Thus, the translator can find out proper translation methods, omission and revivification, to accurately present the meaning of the author.

4.2.1.1 Omission

According to Eugene A. Nida (1984), in the translation process, there is as much as 50% redundancy in some languages. To avoid redundancy, omission is the most effective way to ensure the translation text serves the same expression function as the source text. Thus, omission makes a significant contribution to translating pronouns.

Example 13:

Source text: Rather, our goal is to help you make the right choices for **your** project.

Target text: 相反，本书旨在帮助读者正确选择自己的项目。

Example 14:

Source text: Asking **your** publisher for an extra month of development time or taking out a loan to cover payroll for that month is not ideal, but it's not catastrophic.

Target text: 无论是向发行商征求同意延长一个月的开发时间，还是贷款支

付当月的工资，均非理想做法，但也并非灾难性问题。

In Example 13, the translator should take into account the context rather than analyze this sentence alone. By doing so, the translator will find out that the meaning of the pronoun “your” is contained in the translation of the modified noun “project”, where Coherence Rule works well. So is the case of Example 14 the same situation.

During the translation process of the sentences like the examples mentioned above, the translator should comply with the principle of Skopos Theory to overcome obstacles hindering the translation. According to the main topic of *The Business of Indie Games*, helping indie game makers to make the right choices during the process of making an indie game, the specific solutions and suggestions are targeted to indie game developers. Under such a circumstance, the content seems like a face-to-face conversation between the author and indie game developers, so retaining the meaning of pronouns will make the target text appear to be burdensome, which does not fit the habits of the Chinese expression. Thus, under the guidance of Skopos Rule, Coherence Rule and Fidelity Rule, omission can be the best translation method to fulfill the purpose of the author, reduce cultural barriers between English and Chinese, and make the target text more acceptable for indie game makers.

4.2.1.2 Revivification

Revivification is a common translation method adopted to translate pronouns, which means translating the nouns, the content aforementioned or the infinitive phrase referred by pronouns instead of the basic meaning of them. By doing so, the translator can guarantee the conciseness of the target text and avoid causing misunderstanding to the readers.

Example 15:

Source text: We made this assertion in Part 1, and **it** bears repeating because underestimating the importance of the choices around your project, especially in planning phases, is all too easy for indies.

Target text: 这在第一部分已有所论述。不断强调**这一点**，是因为独立游戏制作人，特别是在项目的规划阶段，往往低估选择之于项目的重要性。

Example 16:

Source text: Just as it was in the previous section on the ecosystem of the games industry, **this** is not about right or wrong answers.

Target text: 正如此前游戏业生态系统部分所述, **这些选择**并没有标准答案。

As the meaning of the pronoun “it” in Example 15 cannot be completely expressed by its definition “它” mentioned in the dictionary, simply translating its basic meaning will even cause misunderstanding among Chinese indie game developers. According to Coherence Rule, “it” refers to “this assertion”, to make targeted audience better accept the meaning of the source text, revivification should be adopted to translate “it” as “这一点” to fulfill the purpose of the translation. In Example 16, under the guidance of Coherence Rule and Fidelity Rule, the pronoun “this” refers to the aforementioned choices according to the context, so revivification should be applied to translate “this” as “这些选择” to accomplish the purpose of Skopos Rule facilitating Chinese indie game makers to have a better understanding of the source text.

As Tytler (2007) holds that the target text should be as natural as the source text to fulfill the function of decent expression, the translation of pronouns should keep Chinese indie game developers from misunderstanding the content of the source text. In this case, revivification can be an appropriate translation method of pronouns. Under the guidance of Skopos Theory, the translator can better find out the nouns referred to by the pronouns, and then revivification is adopted to give a more specific meaning of pronouns to the targeted readers.

4.2.2 Literal Translation and Amplification

Due to the theme of *The Business of Indie Games*, terminology is very common in the source text which mainly explores some professional knowledge about the indie industry. The main obstacle in translating terminology is to know how to make their target text relevant and acceptable for Chinese indie game developers. Thus, literal translation and amplification can be used as proper translation methods during the translation of terminology.

4.2.2.1 Literal Translation

Literal translation refers to retaining the structure of the source text while

translating its actual meaning. After taking into account relevant information from the context, the translator can apply literal translation method to translating terminology, in a bid to accurately get the meaning expressed by the author.

Example 17:

Source text: So, in addition to broader market signals about what players wanted from an indie platformer, *Celeste* also had the benefit of confirming **traction** in its core ideas through lessons learned from Thorson's and Berry's previous games, Thorson's *Super Mario Maker* levels, and the PICO-8 incarnation of *Celeste*.

Target text: 所以,《蔚蓝》除了掌握到更广泛的市场信号,有关玩家所期待的独立平台游戏外,还有一大优势,即利用索尔森和贝瑞过往游戏中学到的经验(索尔森设计的《超级马里奥制造》关卡和《蔚蓝》的前身 PICO-8 游戏),确认了核心创意的**市场欢迎度**。

Example 18:

Source text: Of course you can't expect to be financially successful by ripping off the **premise** of an already popular game (something that is all too common).

Target text: 当然,通过抄袭已然流行的某个游戏**设定**(这已司空见惯),不能指望财源滚滚。

The terminology in the source text mainly refers to the words and expressions different from the definition looked up in the dictionary. In Example 17, "traction" is described as "牵引,附着摩擦力,(肌肉等的)收缩", which does not fit the context (陆谷孙, 2020). So in this situation, the translator should search for information about the mentioned two developers' experiences and some relevant marketing knowledge under the guidance of Skopos Theory, to acquire the meaning of "traction" as "the popularity in the market". Thus, the literal translation should be adopted to translate "traction" as "市场欢迎度" in Chinese. The definition of the terminology "premise" mentioned in Example 18 can be found in *the English-Chinese Dictionary* as "(作为先决条件的)假定,上述各点,生产场所", totally different from the meaning the author tries to express, which means the settings of a game (陆谷孙). Under this circumstance, to make the translation acceptable for Chinese indie game makers, the

translator should apply literal translation to translate “premise” as “设定” in Chinese under the guidance of Skopos Rule and Coherence Rule.

As an appropriate translation method to be applied in the course of translating terminology, under the guidance of Skopos Theory, literal translation facilitates the translator to focus more on Chinese indie game developers, search for more information related to the key words mentioned in the source text, and make every possible effort, in order to make the target text more acceptable and meaningful for targeted audience.

4.2.2.2 Amplification

Amplification refers to adding some words in the course of translation to make the target text more faithful to express the content and thought of the source text (张培基, 喻云根, 李宗杰 & 彭谟禹, 1980). That means amplification smooths the translation of terminology, fully presenting the meaning expressed by the author.

Example 19:

Source text: Most **indies** begin developing games because they are passionate about a game idea, not because they are passionate about the business merits of a digitally distributed interactive product.

Target text: 多数**独立游戏制作人**开发游戏是因为热衷于某个游戏创意，而非为了数字分布式交互产品所带来的商业利益。

Example 20:

Source text: McMillen, who went by **Bluebaby** on Newgrounds, got his start making games in Adobe Flash.

Target text: 麦克米伦在 Newgrounds 开始使用 Adobe Flash 制作游戏,《以撒的结合》中的“**蓝宝宝**”(Bluebaby)也诞生于此。

In Example 19, the terminology “indies” refers to the people making indie games instead of indie games according to the context, and literal translation may miss the key message expressed by the author. Therefore, in such a situation, the translator should consider applying amplification to translate “indies” as “独立游戏制作人” in Chinese under the guidance of Skopos Theory. The translation of the terminology “Bluebaby” in Example 20 should be conducted under the guidance of Coherence

Rule, and Fidelity Rule through searching for information about McMillen to accurately acquire the meaning expressed by the author, in which amplification is adopted to translate “Bluebaby” as “《以撒的结合》中的蓝宝宝” in Chinese.

Amplification applied to the course of translating terminology can fully present the message expressed by the author with the considerations of Skopos Rule, Coherence Rule and Fidelity Rule to focus more on the Chinese indie game makers and remove barriers causing misunderstanding, so the target text may be more acceptable in the Chinese context avoiding information loss as much as possible.

4.2.3 Restructuring and Conversion

Compound sentences with multiple clauses are frequently seen in the source text, which brings a huge obstacle to the course of translation because the translator needs to adjust the order of the clauses in Chinese to present the actual meaning expressed by the author, where cultural differences between English and Chinese should be taken into account. To accurately express compound sentences in the targeted language, the translator selects restructuring and conversion as proper solutions to this difficulty.

4.2.3.1 Restructuring

Restructuring is a translation method to be applied based on the understanding of the inner logic of compound sentences. After dividing the compound sentences into various parts, the translator will restructure these parts in a more acceptable order to better present the meaning in Chinese for targeted audience.

Example 21:

Source text: We will not be able to give you a full tutorial on all of these topics because subjects such as product-market-fit and development management methodologies are full genres of books in their own right, but we will cover the basics with an emphasis on the business considerations.

Target text: 由于产品市场匹配与开发管理方法等主题本身即可独立成书，因此我们无法为上述所有内容提供全面指导，但会侧重阐述商业考量的基础内容。

Example 22:

Source text: They had clearly done their homework and did everything they could

to be ready to pitch their game if they had the chance.

Target text: 他们显然做足了功课，只要有机会，就竭尽所能推介游戏。

In Example 21, the main structure contains an adverbial clause of cause, and according to Coherence Rule, the translator should ponder on the cultural difference between Chinese and English and apply restructuring to translate this clause in the first place in order to emphasize the result, which complies with the expression habit of Chinese. Example 22 consists of an adverbial clause of condition, which will be put in front of the main clause in the Chinese context, so the restructuring should be adopted to translate this adverbial clause first under the guidance of Skopos Theory, so as to facilitate a better understanding of targeted audience.

Restructuring can be used to reorganize the structure of clauses according to their inner logic to present them more appropriately and acceptably way for Chinese indie game developers. Under the guidance of Skopos Theory, especially Coherence Rule, the translator focuses more on linguistic differences between English and Chinese to provide a better and clearer target text for Chinese indie game makers.

4.2.3.2 Conversion

Conversion means changing the pattern of the clause contained in compound sentences to better fit the Chinese context. Under the guidance of Skopos Theory, the translation text should be adjusted in accordance with the Chinese expression to remove the linguistic differences between English and Chinese, where conversion applied to the course of translating compound sentences plays a crucial part.

Example 23:

Source text: That's not bad for an indie game that was 8 years old by the time it got a Switch port, which was also after several other platform releases and years of bundle sales and promotional discounts.

Target text: 一款独立游戏问世 8 年后能够登陆 Switch 端，这是个相当不错的成绩，毕竟，它此前已在其他平台上发行过，还经历了多年的销售捆绑和促销打折。

Example 24:

Source text: The game itself is wonderful, and the size of the splash it has made

since its release in 2013 is so substantial that the importance of the team behind the game can be easy to miss.

Target text: 这款游戏制作精良，自 2013 年发行以来，引起了巨大轰动，其背后的制作团队功不可没。

In Example 23, there is an adverbial clause of time and an attributive clause, which are closely interconnected with each other, so the translator should identify the inner logic between them under the guidance of Coherence Rule, in which the attributive clause gives a clue that the game has launched for eight years and the adverbial clause of time reveals the information that the game gets a Switch port at that time. After that, conversion is adopted to translate these two clauses to better fit the Chinese context in accordance with Skopos Rule and Fidelity Rule. In Example 24, the phrase pattern “so substantial that” is followed by an adverbial clause of result, while according to the expression habits of Chinese, this pattern should be conversed as “引起了巨大轰动，其背后的制作团队功不可没” under the guidance of Skopos Theory.

Conversion is an appropriate translation method to be adopted in translating compound sentences, in order to remove cultural barriers between English and Chinese and better present the actual meaning expressed by the author. Especially when the inner logic of clauses contained in compound sentences are closely interconnected with each other, under the guidance of Coherence Rule and Fidelity Rule, the translator can better apply conversion to present the inner logic of clauses in Chinese to promote a better understanding of targeted audience.

Chapter 5 Conclusion

The previous chapter has given detailed analyses of difficulties in the course of translation, and introduced translation methods applied to smooth the translation project. In this part, the translator will review the whole process of the project, in order to conclude the gains learned in this project and the problems unsolved at present.

5.1 Gains

As the source text is excerpted from a practical book in terms of the game industry, which is a relatively professional field, the translator has encountered a myriad of difficulties during the course of translation. Apart from translation obstacles, the content highly relevant to the game industry has also hindered the author's comprehension. Due to the benefits of hindsight, the translator will look back at the whole process of the project, in a bid to summarize valuable lessons learned in the course of translation.

When translating a source text that the translator is not familiar with, especially referring to a professional field, the translator should make a clear plan to guide the whole translation project in the first place. At the very beginning phase, the translator should read through the whole book to get a general picture of its main idea, identifying basic translation difficulties and the main subjects contained in the book. After that, the translator can better conduct a thorough research about the subjects referred in the source text, to get adequate information from articles and books both in the source language and the target language. By doing so, the translator can accumulate enough related knowledge which is needed in the course of comprehending and translating the source text, and can grasp expression habits of the targeted language which will smooth the translation project. When preparation work has been fully accomplished, the translator should begin to take the translation difficulties into account, and determine which translation theory is adopted to fulfill

the purpose of the project.

Although this is not a perfect practice, if the translator follows all the steps above, the translation process will become much easier. Faced with such difficulties as the abundance use of pronouns, terminology regarding the game industry, and compound sentences with multiple clauses, the translator has thought carefully about how to make the translation text more acceptable for targeted audience, and found appropriate methods can be adopted to facilitate the translation of these difficulties.

When translating pronouns, the translator can adhere to the principles below to determine whether to omit pronouns or apply revivification to translate pronouns as the nouns referred: when pronouns, without special meaning, modify nouns and the translation of nouns contains the meaning of pronouns, in this condition pronouns can be omitted; when pronouns do not have the concrete meaning and the misunderstanding will be caused to targeted audience by simply translating the basic meaning of pronouns, pronouns should be translated through the application of revivification.

Terminology in the source text should be recognized according to specific standards, and the translation methods adopted should comply with the purpose of facilitation of better understanding of targeted audience. In the translation of terminology, the key point is to search for information relevant to the context to better acquire the meaning expressed by the author. To apply literal translation or amplification to the translation depends on which one can ensure the complete message has been presented to targeted audience.

In the course of translating compound sentences, when the order of clauses complies with the expression habits of Chinese, the structure can be retained. While the order does not fit the Chinese context, especially when there are adverbial clauses contained in the compound sentences, restructuring should be adopted to make the target text fit the Chinese context. Conversion will be applied in the process of translation when the clause patterns are not commonly seen in Chinese, so the translator should consider changing the pattern to be suitable for the Chinese context, in a bid to improve the translation to be more understandable and acceptable for

targeted audience.

5.2 Problems to be Solved

In the translation of this project, the translator has improved a lot in translating pronouns, terminology and compound sentences, and has been better familiar with some translation methods which will help the translator go further in the field of translation. But there are still some problems unsolved in this project. Compound sentences with multiple clauses, whose structures appear to be simple without difficult grammar or words, are difficult for the translator to accurately express their meaning in Chinese. That means the content of the sentence is easy enough to be mastered by the translator, but when the translator wants to express it in Chinese, the translator cannot find as concise and natural expression as the source text to present the translation to targeted audience. This problem is caused due to an inadequate mastery of Chinese expression, and the translator still has much to learn in translation. Thus, in the future, the translator needs to improve Chinese proficiency to make the translation text more suitable for the Chinese context and further explore translation theories and methods to enhance translation skills to accurately express the content the author intends to convey.

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Appendix I Source Text—中文译文

Source Text	中文译文
Chapter Five Project Types and Project Goals	第五章 项目类型及目标
The fate of many games is decided before the first line of code is ever written.	在第一行代码编写前,很多游戏的命运已成定局。
We made this assertion in Part 1, and it bears repeating because underestimating the importance of the choices around your project, especially in planning phases, is all too easy for indies. The fun part of indie game development is making the game. Bringing your characters, story, and world to life is magical, and then seeing players experience that content is even more magical. Most indies begin developing games because they are passionate about a game idea, not because they are passionate about the business merits of a digitally distributed interactive product.	这在第一部分已有所论述。不断强调这一点,是因为独立游戏制作人,特别是在项目的规划阶段,往往低估选择之于项目的重要性。独立游戏开发的乐趣在于制作游戏:将构想的角色、故事、世界塑造成一款游戏非常奇妙,而看到玩家体验这一切则更奇妙。多数独立游戏制作人开发游戏是因为热衷于某个游戏创意,而非为了数字分布式交互产品所带来的商业利益。
These planning choices are not just about budgets and sales projections either. Everything from the genre you choose to the engine you use to the timing of your release can impact the financial success of your game. Each choice in the development process ripples into the others, and while you can't anticipate every possible decision you will have to make as an indie, our hope is that this book helps you anticipate the options that many indies overlook.	规划阶段中的选择不仅是指项目预算和销售预期,还包括所选游戏类型、所用游戏引擎以及游戏发行时机等,这些都会影响游戏的经济收益。同样,开发过程中的每一次选择也会对其他方面产生涟漪效应。尽管独立游戏制作人无法预测到可能出现的每一个选择,但本书希望能帮助读者窥见多数独立游戏制作人所忽视的选择。

Pre-Development Overview	预开发阶段概述
In this part of the book, we will explore the myriad of pre-development decisions you will encounter as an indie. Just as it was in the previous section on the ecosystem of the games industry, this is not about right or wrong answers. Rather, our goal is to help you make the right choices for your project. In that spirit, we will walk you through the hidden implications around choices that might seem inconsequential—such as whether you use GameMaker or Unity for your engine – and how those choices could influence how you work with publishers, how you work with platforms, and how you ultimately engage players.	本书的这一部分将探讨独立游戏制作人在预开发阶段可能会面临的无数选择。正如此前游戏业生态系统部分所述,这些选择并没有标准答案。相反,本书旨在帮助读者正确选择自己的项目。鉴于此,我们将阐明一些看似无关紧要的选择所隐含的影响,例如游戏引擎是选择 GameMaker 还是 Unity,并说明这些选择将会如何影响与游戏发行商、各游戏平台之间的合作方式,以及最终吸引游戏玩家的方式。
At a high-level, this section explores the following: ●Setting project goals based on your means and your aspirations ●The types of projects you might explore as an indie ●How to assess the business potential of a particular genre ●How to evaluate the market potential of your game concept ●How choosing an art style impacts development and pitching ●Establishing a scope for your development ●Choosing an engine and how engine-selection	在此高度上,本节将探讨以下内容: ●基于能力与预期设定项目目标 ●独立游戏制作人可能开发的项目类型 ●评估某类游戏商业潜力的方式 ●评估游戏概念市场潜力的方式 ●游戏美术风格的选择影响游戏开发和推介的方式 ●设定游戏开发范围 ●引擎选择及其影响游戏业务的方式 ●确定开发时间线及里程碑 ●说明游戏翻译与本地化 ●独立游戏制作人预算规划的实用方法 ●组建并管理独立游戏开发团队

affects the business of a game ●Determining development timelines and milestones ●Accounting for translation and localization ●A practical approach to budget planning for indies ●Building and managing an indie development team	
We will not be able to give you a full tutorial on all of these topics because subjects such as product-market-fit and development management methodologies are full genres of books in their own right, but we will cover the basics with an emphasis on the business considerations.	由于产品市场匹配与开发管理方法等主题本身即可独立成书,因此我们无法为上述所有内容提供全面指导,但会侧重阐述商业考量的基础内容。
How to Use This Section for True Pre-Development	如何在实际预开发阶段中运用本章节的内容
You probably have an idea for the game you want to make, or more likely you have several and might be trying to choose where to start. If you are at this stage in your indie journey where you haven't actually started making your game, or are very early, this section will give you a step-by-step guide for a thorough indie game planning process. In each section, you can work along in a notebook or a GDD (game design document) to write out an initial plan for your game.	可能读者已经拥有一个或好几个有关游戏制作的想 法,正纠结从何入手。如果独立游戏之旅还未进入正式制作游戏的阶段,或处于游戏制作初期,那么本节将逐步指导读者制定详尽的独立游戏规划。阅读每个章节时,都可以使用笔记本或 GDD (游戏设计文档) 记录初始游戏方案。
Think of this initial plan as a rough draft. A	初始方案可以作为草稿,毕竟第一次迭代的

development plan for a game is rarely perfect in its first iteration. A choice in one area, like a target release date, can trigger a cascade of adjustments in other areas. If you want to release in Q1 of a particular year, as an example, all of your development milestones will need to align accordingly.	游戏开发方案几乎难以臻近完美。牵一发而动全身，任何一个微小的选择，如目标发布日期，可能都会引起其他方面一连串的调整。例如，如果想在某年的第一季度发行游戏，则需要相应调整所有的开发里程碑。
That could mean adjusting the scope of your game to fit that timing, or it could mean hiring additional team members so that you can complete the full scope of the game as planned and still hit your release window. Changing the scope of your game or opting to expand your team also triggers follow-up considerations. You may need to adjust the pricing for your game to better reflect the total content, or you may need to pursue publishers with larger funding budgets.	这意味着需要调整游戏范围来适应发行时间，或雇佣更多团队成员，以便按计划完成游戏的全部范围，并如期进入发布窗口。改变游戏规模，或选择扩大团队，也都会引起后续事项的变动。为了更好地体现出游戏的全部内容，可能需要调整游戏定价，或者与预算资金更高的发行商合作。
Planning is a fluid endeavor. That is to say, most plans will need updating during the development process. Part of your planning should be to imagine a variety of outcomes, obstacles, and opportunities so that you can revise your plan as you take in new information. You might not be able to anticipate everything, but the more you do anticipate, the easier it will be to adapt to the real surprises.	规划过程历经变化与调整。也就是说，在开发过程中需要更新大多数的方案。规划应该包括对项目设想的各种结果、困难与机遇，以便在获取新信息时能够改进方案。预测项目中的所有内容可能不太现实，但预测越全面，越能轻松应对真实的突发情况。
As you plan, conduct thought experiments with your project, and ask yourself questions such as the following while you work through each	制定方案时，需要在项目中进行这种预测思维实验；落实方案各个环节时，则需要问自己以下问题：

element of your plan: ●What opportunities do I create with this choice? ●What obstacles am I likely to encounter that I should plan for? ●What other areas does this choice affect? ●How would the project change if I changed this variable? ●What elements am I willing to change and why? ●Under what circumstances am I willing to change them? ●How would this plan change if the project funding changed (self-publishing vs. working with a publisher)?	●这个选择会带来什么机会? ●可能遇到什么困难, 又该如何计划? ●这个选择会影响其他哪些方面? ●如果改变这个变量, 项目将如何变化? ●愿意改动哪些环节, 为什么? ●在何种情况下会愿意做出这些改动? ●如果项目筹资方式发生改变(个人发行对与发行商合作), 方案将如何变化?
If you have a team, these questions can help to drive group discussions around how you want to bring your game to life and bring to market. If you are a solo developer, these questions will help you to reflect on your plan and uncover perspectives that might not have been immediately obvious.	如果是游戏团队, 上述问题将推动团队讨论游戏付诸于现实并进入市场的方式。如果是独立游戏制作人, 这些问题有助于反思方案, 并挖掘出他人有所忽视的观点。
These exercises, for as abstract as they might feel, can prevent many of the most common project-killing problems for indie developers.	这些预测练习虽然看似抽象, 却能让独立游戏制作人避开很多导致项目终结的最为常见的问题。
How to Use This Section for Retroactive Pre-Development	如何在追溯预开发阶段中运用本章节的内容
If your project is already underway – and we expect this to be the case for many readers – do	如果项目已经步入启动阶段(估计多数读者都是如此), 也不必灰心丧气。除了已投入

not despair. Aside from the budget you may have already invested or contracts you may have signed, few development decisions are truly permanent. In cases where it is impractical to turn back, like a year of development in a particular engine, the ideas we explore in this section can help illuminate potential opportunities that may have been otherwise hidden.	的预算或已签订的合同,开发阶段的选择少有一成不变的。在无法重来的情况下,如利用一年时间开发特定引擎,本章探讨的内容有助于阐明这些选择背后潜在的机遇。
Likewise, you may still have time to avoid critical landmines.	同样,可能还有时间避免未形之患。
With the timeline of development for the average indie game – ranging from one to two years in most cases – the real importance of pre-development choices is understanding what they mean in the long term, so even if the choice is already made, you have much to gain by seeing more clearly what path those choices can put you on.	多数情况下,独立游戏的平均开发时长为一至两年,预开发阶段中作出选择的关键在于理解其对于长远发展的意义。因此,即使已经作出了选择,了解这些选择带来的不同发展路径,也能让你受益匪浅。
If you are an indie and your project has already begun, all of the knowledge we impart in this section will still apply, but how you use it will be somewhat different than if you started your indie journey with this book.	如果你是独立游戏制作人,且项目已经步入启动阶段,这部分探讨的所有内容仍然适用,但用法稍微不同于阅读本书后再开始独立游戏制作之旅的方式。
For the indies, already in development, here's how to apply pre-development concepts: ●Map the choices you have made around your project already to clearly see where you are and what has been decided	对于项目已经处于开发阶段的独立游戏制作人而言,以下是运用预开发概念的方式: ●列出已作的项目选择,以便清晰了解自己的位置与已形成的决策 ●识别开发阶段中深思熟虑的方面,并列举

●Identify the aspects of your development that were deeply deliberate and outline your reasoning for making those choices ●Identify the aspects of your development where your choices were less intentional and you did not fully consider the consequences ●Based on what the material we review, brainstorm on what those consequences might be and what that means for your project ●Review your development map with this new clarity and look for weaknesses and strengths that were previously hidden to you ●Update your plan to address the weaknesses and to capitalize on the strengths	作出这些选择的理由 ●识别开发阶段非刻意选择且未充分考虑后果的方面 ●基于回顾的材料，头脑风暴可能的后果及其之于项目的意义 ●用全新清晰的思路回顾开发过程图，找出之前忽视的项目劣势与优势 ●更新方案以解决项目劣势并充分利用项目优势
For example, you might have chosen GameMaker as an engine because you found it accessible and easy to use, which is completely reasonable. However, you may not have known that some publishers prefer to publish GameMaker titles and that certain genres of GameMaker titles are likely to do well on Xbox and Switch because of player preferences. You also might not have known that the community around GameMaker can be a marketing opportunity in its own right, spanning Reddit communities and Facebook groups in addition to GameMaker's own Showcase efforts.	例如，因为 GameMaker 既方便获取又容易使用，已经被选作游戏引擎，这样的选择合情合理。却不知道一些发行商更青睐发行 GameMaker 的游戏，而且由于玩家的偏好，特定种类的 GameMaker 游戏在 Xbox 和 Switch 上表现更好。殊不知 GameMaker 社区本身就是营销机会，除了自身的宣传渠道，它还涵盖红迪网（Reddit）社区和脸书（Facebook）群组。
There might be cons, of course, to having	当然，游戏引擎选择 GameMaker 可能存在

chosen GameMaker as an engine (which we will talk about as well), but in this quick example, we have touched on several points that could have a big impact on your business plan. You could, today, start to target GameMaker-friendly publishers and become more active in GameMaker communities with the hopes of unlocking new potential benefits.	弊端（也会讨论这一点），但是上述例子涉及的几点内容，能够对商业方案产生巨大影响。今后，可以将青睐 GameMaker 的发行商作为目标合作对象，并且在 GameMaker 社区保持活跃度，以期解锁新的潜在福利。
Your inherent creativity as an indie will serve you well here. Use your current trajectory as a springboard for imagining possibilities and for ideating on how you might seize the most worthwhile of those possibilities. While planning earlier is always better, you can almost always open new doors for your work no matter where you are in development.	独立游戏制作人天生的创造力将在这方面予以充分助力。基于现有的开发规划，想象开发过程中的各种可能性，并且思考怎样才能把握其中最有价值的部分。尽管规划得越早越好，但无论开发处于哪个阶段，项目几乎总能找到新思路。
Project Types and Project Goals	项目类型及目标
Before you build the details for your grand development plan, defining your basic goals and aspirations can help frame the other choices you make around your project. The plan for a game that funds the overhead of a 10-person team and builds the runway for funding a follow-up title will be a much different plan from the plan for a solo indie working on their game on nights and weekends.	在为宏大的开发方案制定细节之前，基本目标及期望的确定有助于拟定项目的其他选择。能够维持 10 人团队营运且提供资金支持后续游戏开发的游戏方案，截然不同于独立游戏制作人利用夜晚与周末时光开发游戏的方案。
In the world of indie games, both paths are perfectly viable, but the plans will tackle unique problems.	在独立游戏行业中，上述两种方式都切实可行，但不同的方案各得其宜地解决问题。

We tend to put indie game projects into five different buckets: ●Hobby projects – Game jams or small side projects that might have commercial value but are really more about learning and experimentation ●Self-published projects – A full game designed to succeed without the support and funding of a publisher or investor ●Traditionally published projects – A full game designed to require publisher funding and support to be successful ●Early Access projects – These titles could ultimately be self-published or released in partnership with a publisher, but the development includes leveraging Steam’s Early Access community ●Crowdfunded projects – Ranging widely in scope, these projects are designed with the additional beat of funding traction on a crowdfunding platform well before the full launch	我们倾向于将独立游戏项目分为五类： ●兴趣项目：限时游戏开发活动(game jams)或小型业余项目，可能具备商业价值，但本质是进行游戏开发实验并从中学习 ●个人发行项目：不依靠发行商或投资人的支持与投资，旨在成功发行的完整版游戏 ●传统发行项目：依靠发行商的投资与支持，旨在成功发行的完整版游戏 ●抢先体验项目：这些游戏最终可以由个人发行或与发行商合作发行，但其开发过程需要利用 Steam 抢先体验社区 ●众筹项目：这些项目范围颇广，旨在完整发行前从众筹平台获得更多资金支持
The needs of each project will necessitate a unique plan on top of all of the other choices you have to make about the game itself – genre, art, scope, engine, and so on. Let’s explore each of these in greater depth to fully illustrate how varying goals lead to different kinds of plans.	除了游戏本身的选择之外（游戏类型、美术风格、游戏范围、游戏引擎等），还需要根据每一个项目的不同需求，制定特定的方案。接下来会深入探讨上述各个项目类型，充分说明不同的目标所带来的方案迥异。
Hobby Game Projects	兴趣游戏项目

Indies often make the mistake of trying to make their first game their best game. While this can sometimes be the case, the more likely reality is that your first game will be your worst game. Game design and development are difficult skills to learn and master, so most successful indies start their journeys with smaller hobby projects. Instead of spending three years on 10 hours of platforming content, they might spend a day (as is common in the “Game Jam” format) or a few weeks to bring a simpler game to life.	试图让首个游戏就成为巅峰之作，是独立游戏制作人常犯的错误。虽然也不是没有发生过这种事情，但现实更可能恰恰相反。游戏设计与开发技能难以学习掌握，因此多数成功的独立游戏制作人的职业生涯都是始于小型兴趣项目。比起花三年的时间制作时长10小时的平台游戏，他们可能更愿意花一天（限时游戏开发活动的常见时长）或几周来完成一款更为简单的游戏。
Hobby projects give you room to fail. Without going too far into being an over-the-top motivational speaker, failure is actually an overwhelmingly positive outcome for a creative. Failure means you tried something new and learned in the process.	可以在兴趣项目中试错。不用听励志演说家夸夸其谈，创作者也能明白失败其实是极其积极的结果。失败意味着你尝试了新事物，并从中有所收获。
Most game jams – which is a format where developers try to make a game in a set amount of time, often a day – create a slew of games that are objectively “bad” from a commercial perspective. Even if the developers execute on their initial concept, the art is usually janky and the controls are a bit wonky, but making a commercial game isn’t the point.	多数限时游戏开发活动，即开发者在规定的时间内（通常为一天）制作游戏的一种形式，产生了大量商业价值“不良”的游戏。即使开发者实现了最初的游戏构想，制作出来的游戏却往往呈现出简陋的美术风格、不太稳定的操作感。但限时游戏开发活动的重点并非制作商业游戏。
The point is to learn so that your next game can be better as a result.	该活动的重点是学习，从而优化下一款游戏的制作。
The common missed opportunity for hobby projects is to also practice your planning skills.	通常在兴趣项目中错失的机会也能锻炼规划能力。由于兴趣项目的风险几乎可以忽略

The stakes might feel so low that doing a full GDD and a business plan for your goofy <i>Mario</i> ripoff is unnecessary, but these are actually the best ways to hone your ability to anticipate and address challenges. The scale of the project means you have less to wrangle overall, but all of the considerations you have to make are the same.	不计，就会理所当然地认为没必要为从《马里奥》中获得灵感的整脚项目制作完整的游戏设计文档与商业方案，但实际上这些都是提升预测能力与应对挑战能力的最佳方式。项目规模小意味着整个项目需要纠结的内容更少，但需要考虑的事项却并无二致。
If you apply the planning ideas in this book to your hobby projects, you will find it far easier to scale up into a commercial project.	如果将本书的规划思路运用到自己的兴趣项目中，将其扩大为商业游戏则更轻而易举。
Edmund McMillen, a name you might recognize from games like <i>Super Meat Boy</i> and the immensely successful <i>The Binding of Isaac</i> series, is a glowing example of how starting with small hobby projects can lead to a successful career as an indie.	在《超级食肉男孩》(<i>Super Meat Boy</i>) 与大获成功的《以撒的结合》(<i>The Binding of Isaac</i>) 系列游戏中，你可能看到过艾德姆德·麦克米伦 (Edmund McMillen) 的名字。他是个鲜活的例子，让大众得以了解小型兴趣项目如何引导独立游戏制作人走向成功。
McMillen, who went by Bluebaby on Newgrounds, got his start making games in Adobe Flash. By most standards, Flash games are much simpler than commercial games. Fans of this medium – most of whom are counting grey hairs as Flash fades from memory – expected quick experiences, and developers obliged. Most Flash developers were making projects for fun anyway, and the nature of Flash meant that large file sizes were impractical.	麦克米伦在 Newgrounds 开始使用 Adobe Flash 制作游戏，《以撒的结合》中的“蓝宝宝” (Bluebaby) 也诞生于此。大多数标准都表明 Flash 游戏比商业游戏简单得多。Adobe Flash 的粉丝期待的是快速的游戏体验 (随着该工具逐渐淡出视野，多数粉丝也上了年纪)，而开发者满足了这种需求。无论如何，大多数 Adobe Flash 开发者因为兴趣制作游戏，这个工具在本质上就不适合开发大型游戏。
As a result, most Flash games lasted a few minutes at most, and McMillen’s work fit this	所以，多数 Flash 游戏的时长最多就几分钟，麦克米伦的游戏满足这个特点。

mold.	
<i>Meat Boy</i> , the precursor to <i>Super Meat Boy</i> , began as a Flash game in 2008 and took only three weeks to make. Though it was not a huge game, it was fun, and as the views of the game ticked into the hundreds of thousands, Nintendo and Microsoft took notice. They both wanted a full-fledged version of <i>Meat Boy</i> for their platforms, which were WiiWare and Xbox Live Arcade at the time.	《食肉男孩》(<i>Meat Boy</i>)是《超级食肉男孩》的前身,其雏形是麦克米伦于2008年仅花费3周时间制作的一款Flash游戏。虽然该游戏规模不大,却趣味十足,随着其点击量达到数十万后,任天堂(Nintendo)和微软(Microsoft)注意到了它。彼时,这两个公司的平台(分别是WiiWare和Xbox Live Arcade)都想拥有完整版《食肉男孩》。
<i>Super Meat Boy</i> launched in 2010. By 2012, the game had sold more than a million copies.	《超级食肉男孩》于2010年发行,截至2012年,销量已逾百万。
In 2018, <i>Super Meat Boy</i> got a Switch port—another example of the long-tail sales potential of an indie game that we discussed in the previous section—and a spokesperson told Kotaku, “I don’t know if I’m allowed to give out specific numbers, but I can say that for Team Meat, SMB Switch made more money on it’s day one than our XBLA launch on Oct. 20th, 2010.”	2018年,《超级食肉男孩》登录Switch端,这再一次证明了前述章节讨论过的独立游戏长尾销售潜力,微软的发言人在写给Kotaku网站的邮件中表示:“我不知道能否透露具体数据,但可以肯定,Team Meat在Switch版《超级食肉男孩》发行的第一天所获得的收益,远高于2010年10月20日XBLA版发行当天的收益。”
That’s not bad for an indie game that was 8 years old by the time it got a Switch port, which was also after several other platform releases and years of bundle sales and promotional discounts.	一款独立游戏问世8年后能够登陆Switch端,这是个相当不错的成绩,毕竟,它此前已在其他平台上发行过,还经历了多年的销售捆绑和促销打折。
The DNA that made <i>Super Meat Boy</i> a commercial success is clearly visible in the Newgrounds version of <i>Meat Boy</i> . Yes, <i>Super</i>	《超级食肉男孩》能取得商业成功的特质在新grounds版《食肉男孩》中清晰可见。的确,《超级食肉男孩》的规模更大,关数

<i>Meat Boy</i> is much bigger. It has more levels. It has more mechanics. The art and controls are more polished. But the hobby version gave McMillen room to explore the core ideas. Three weeks of work is a lot of effort, but if the game had lopped after that, it would have been far less painful than if he had worked for three years only to discover that players had no interest in a game like <i>Meat Boy</i>.	更多，机制更丰富，美术风格和游戏操作感经过精心优化。但正是兴趣项目版《食肉男孩》激发麦克米伦探索出《超级食肉男孩》的核心创意。诚然他在《食肉男孩》三周的开发工作中倾注了大量心血，即便在此之后游戏依旧失败，所承受的痛苦却远比耗费三年时间才发现玩家对《食肉男孩》这样的游戏毫无兴趣要小得多。
Additionally, McMillen's Newgrounds profile is still live, and his upload history has 34 content submissions before the 2008 upload of <i>Meat Boy</i>, with his first uploads starting in 2001. If you browse through these uploads, you can see glimmers of the ideas that would evolve into <i>Super Meat Boy</i> and <i>The Binding of Isaac</i>, but there are also a lot of out there uploads as well.	此外，现在仍能搜索到麦克米伦的 Newgrounds 主页，在 2008 年上传《食肉男孩》之前，他已经上传了 34 款游戏，首次上传记录可以追溯到 2001 年。如果浏览这些上传记录，则能够发现这些游戏的精妙创意最终都融进了《超级食肉男孩》与《以撒的结合》，但上传记录之外的诸多游戏也同样为之提供了灵感。
<i>Blood Car 2000!</i> looks and plays nothing like the games that made McMillen an indie legend – it's a game about running over zombies with your car – and it was not a breakout success either. One reviewer wrote, "this game is shit, good to play without fingernails though."	《血车 2000 !》(<i>Blood Car 2000 !</i>) 是麦克米伦制作的一款开车辗轧丧尸的游戏，无论是风格还是玩法，都完全不同他的经典之作，因此未能取得突破性的成功。一名玩家评论：“这个游戏非常烂，没手都能玩。”
If you look hard enough, you can find indie stories where the developer's very first game was their breakout success, rocketing their career into orbit. Practically speaking, though, most indie success stories align more closely with McMillen's. Seven years of small experiments	如果观察足够仔细，你能在一些独立游戏制作人的经历中发现，他们的处女作大获成功，直接让自己的职业生涯步入正轨。然而事实上，多数成功的独立游戏制作人的经历更趋同于麦克米伦。在小型游戏实验及项目上耗费 7 年时光，最终让《食肉男孩》得以

and small projects built up to <i>Meat Boy</i> , and because McMillen was so active on Newgrounds, we can more clearly look at the path he took to become the force he is today.	问世,通过 Newgrounds 上留存的活跃记录,我们能够更加明白他成为如今的独立游戏界泰斗所走过的路。
That story for other developers is largely obscured because most one-off experiments never leave the developer's hard drive. They are born and die with no real public release, giving players the illusion that an indie's first commercial game is their first game ever. That's simply not how it usually happens.	由于大多数一次性游戏实验都从未留下开发者的开发记录,因此他们的经历通常也就无从探究。这些游戏从诞生到终止都从未真正的公开发行,导致玩家误以为独立游戏制作人发行的第一款商业游戏都是他们的第一个游戏。通常事实并非如此。
Because our goal for this book is to help you become a successful indie, we feel we need to emphasize how important hobby projects can be in your career. If you are new to making games, start with small manageable projects. Don't worry about them being good in the <i>Metacritic</i> since of the idea of good.	本书致力于帮助读者成为成功的独立游戏制作人,因此有必要强调兴趣项目之于职业生涯的重要性。如果你在游戏制作方面还是新手,那么就从小规模易管理的游戏项目入手。只要游戏创意足够精妙,就不用担心 <i>Metacritic</i> 上评论的褒贬。
Experiment. Practice. Fail. Learn. You are likely to find that one of your hobby projects blossoms into your first commercial success. We saw this firsthand with <i>Turnip Boy Commits Tax Evasion</i> . The Snoozy Kazoo team made the first iteration as a game jam project with no real intention of making it a full-time project, but as happened with <i>Meat Boy</i> , the reaction from players was too big to ignore.	进行游戏实验,提升制作技术,过程中可能会失败,但也能从中学习。你可能会发现某个兴趣项目最终发展成自己首个成功的商业游戏。《大头菜小子避税历险记》(<i>Turnip Boy Commits Tax Evasion</i>) 的开发经历就是最好的证明。在限时游戏开发活动中, Snoozy Kazoo 团队完成了该游戏的第一次迭代,他们当时并未打算全职制作这款游戏,但同《食肉男孩》一样,在玩家中引起的巨大反响扭转了团队此前的想法。
And now they too are an indie success story.	现在,他们也成为了独立游戏的传奇人物。

Self-Published Projects	个人发行项目
Technically, as soon as you upload your game anywhere, it has been “published.” For our purposes here, though, we are focusing more on the intention. If you upload a game jam project to Itch.io because you want to share it with friends, we would still consider that a hobby project.	从技术层面而言，只要你上传了游戏，无论是上传到哪里，这款游戏都被视为“已发行”。然而，考虑到本节目标，此处更注重上传目的。如果是为了跟朋友分享游戏，才将限时游戏开发活动的项目上传到 Itch.io，那么该游戏仍是兴趣项目。
If instead you are uploading a game to make a profit to offset the time and money you invested into development, that is more in line with what we mean by self-publishing. You made the game with the intention of making a profit on it, presumably so you could continue making games.	相反，如果上传游戏是为了求利，以抵消开发中投入的时间及资金成本，则更符合个人发行的定义。制作游戏的目的是从中盈利，认为这样才能继续制作游戏。
For indies, self-publishing is only getting easier. Releasing a game on Steam is relatively painless, and solo developers have successfully self-published on consoles like Switch, PlayStation, and Xbox as well.	独立游戏制作人个人发行游戏易如反掌。不费吹灰之力即可在 Steam 上发行游戏，在游戏机上的个人发行也能大获成功，如任天堂的 Switch、索尼的 PlayStation、微软的 Xbox。
As we discussed in Chapter 1, self-publishing ultimately means taking on all of the responsibilities of a publisher and executing on them yourself. If you don’t account for that workload in your planning, you may discover significant holes in your budget with no funds available to fill them. Another common problem in not planning for these responsibilities is many will focus on development first before then marketing the game just before launch. This does not give time to build an audience and will likely	正如第一章所述，个人发行意味着承担并亲自履行发行商的全部职责。如果不在规划中说明这些工作内容，可能会发现预算中存在重大漏洞，且没有可用以填补的资金。未将这些职责纳入规划还会带来另一个常见的问题，即很多人将游戏开发放在首位，在游戏发行前才想起该营销游戏了。这种做法导致经营游戏受众时间不足，最终可能会致使游戏发行失败。

have a launch fall flat.	
Self-publishing should be a strategic business choice. Here are some of the signs self-publishing might be the right path for your game: ● You have the budget to self-fund the project ● You or your team have significant technical and marketing expertise to cover the majority of the responsibilities a publisher would take on ● You are focused on one to two platforms for the initial release ● Your sales expectations are unlikely to justify a publisher commitment ● You have the financial resources to grow slowly overtime ● You have a behind-the-scenes partner to connect you with the right industry insiders	个人发行应该是策略性的商业选择。以下是一些标志，表明游戏适合个人发行： ● 预算充足能够自费完成项目 ● 个人或团队的技术及市场营销专业知识过硬，能够履行发行商的大部分责任 ● 游戏首发专注于一至两个平台 ● 销售预期可能无法说服发行商合作 ● 财务资源稳步缓慢增长 ● 幕后伙伴能联系到合适的业内人士
Self-publishing could also be the wrong choice for your game. If you ignore key signs that this is the case, you could doom or severely hinder your project by pursuing self-publishing. Some of those signs are as follows: ● You do not and will not have the budget to complete your game in its current scope ● Your team has very little marketing experience and no existing fan community ● You have little experience with engaging games journalists and streamers to get press coverage ● You or your team are missing key technical skills, especially as it relates to porting	游戏也可能不适合个人发行，如果忽视了这种情况的关键标志，盲目追求个人发行，项目可能会失败或受到严重影响。一些不适合个人发行的标志如下： ● 当下和未来都没有足够的预算完成当前范围的游戏开发 ● 团队几乎没有市场营销经验，也没有粉丝社群 ● 很少为了游戏宣传报道跟游戏记者及主播打交道 ● 个人或团队缺乏关键技术及技能，尤其是让游戏登录端机的能力 ● 清楚注入资源或支持将大幅提高游戏销

●You can clearly see how an injection of resources or supports would dramatically improve the sales potential of the project	量潜力
Put another way, these are considerations that indies often overlook when they self-publish. We emphasize that perspective because you may be able to address these points to clear a path to self-publishing.	换句话说,这些是独立游戏制作人在个人发行时常常忽视的情况。之所以强调这一观点,是因为解决这些问题能够为个人发行扫清障碍。
From a business point of view, self-publishing has a few big advantages over publishing that make it strategically attractive. When you are in complete control of the game launch, you can retain the majority of the profits as well as all of the rights to the intellectual property tied to the game. The big danger, however, is overestimating how much profit you can generate with no help beyond what you or your team are capable of doing.	从商业角度而言,相较于发行,个人发行的几大优势让游戏发行在战略上更具吸引力。全权负责游戏发行时,能够保留大部分的游戏收益以及全部的游戏知识产权。然而,在超过自身或者团队能力范围且没有外界帮助的情况下,高估所能创造的收益数额是风险所在。
This takes us back to our profit math from Part 1. The natural reaction for many indies is to recoil when they think about how much of their profit a platform or a publisher takes from a sale. It can immediately feel unfair, and the nature of the indie spirit has a built-in willingness to go-it-alone. So, faced with those numbers, why wouldn't you just self-publish and keep all of the profit for the people who actually built the game?	这就要说回第一部分的利润数学。很多独立游戏制作人想到平台或发行商将从销量中分走大量利润时,打退堂鼓是其最自然的本能反应。这当然会让人觉得不公平,况且独立精神的本质在于单打独斗的内在意愿。所以,面对巨额收益,为何不个人发行游戏,只跟真正参与制作的团队成员瓜分利润呢?
Well, the short-term win could mean giving up on long-term profits that might be substantial.	当然,短期甜头可能意味着放弃长期可观的收益。

Let's say that, hypothetically, you are running an incredibly lean development timeline. If a publisher gave you \$20,000 in additional funding, you could add four months of development to your game, taking it from a small hobby project to a full-fledged game experience. On top of that, the publisher commits a \$10,000 marketing budget.	假设正在运行的开发时间线效率极高。如果发行商追加了 2 万美元的资金,则游戏开发周期能够延长 4 个月,此举足以让该游戏从小型兴趣项目发展成高度成熟的完整版游戏。除此之外,发行商还承诺了 1 万美元的市场营销预算。
If that enables you to retail the game at \$9.99 instead of \$4.99, that alone expands the profit potential of the game significantly, but if we return to the math we started in Chapter 3, we can see more clearly how this story might play out:	如果这能够让游戏零售价定为 9.99 美元而非 4.99 美元,仅此一点,就可以让游戏收益潜力大幅提高,但如果我们回顾第三章探讨的数学,则会更清楚利润大幅提升是如何实现的:
Remember that Steam takes 30% for a platform fee, leaving \$6.99 in profit per sale. That means that you need to sell approximately 4,292 units for the publisher to recoup their investment (make their money back), at which point you start to get a share of each sale.	还记得 Steam 收取 30% 的平台费,所以每单销售的剩余利润为 6.99 美元。这意味着需要销售大约 4292 份游戏,发行商才能收回投资(也就是赚回投资费用),此后开发者才开始在每单销售中分成。
Is that reasonable for your project? Maybe. Maybe not. You would need to benchmark your game against similar titles in the genre to get a realistic view of what sales potential might be, and then you would need to find the right publisher who has the performance track record your game needs.	这对项目合理吗?答案不确定。需要根据风格类似的游戏的实际销售潜力,对游戏进行评估,然后找到拥有游戏所需业绩记录的合适发行商进行合作。
At the same time, though, you should be highly critical of your own ability to drive game sales. For example, if you find that your Wishlist	然而与此同时,你应该高度批判性地看待自己推动游戏销量的能力。例如,如果在游戏登录 Steam 数月之后,发现愿望单数量几乎

numbers are barely moving after a few months of your Steam page being live, the averages around Wishlist conversions (19 percent on average become sales, as discussed in Chapter 4) could reveal that your game is heading toward a failed launch and it might be wise to revise your strategy.	没有增加, 愿望单转化率均值能表明游戏发行即将失败 (第四章讨论过平均 19% 转化为销量), 那么调整策略也许是明智之举。
The revision could still mean self-publishing but with a much larger marketing effort—a new hire or an outside consultant—or it could mean pivoting the project and hunting for a publisher.	调整后仍然可以选择个人发行, 但是需要加大市场营销力度, 如雇佣新员工或外聘顾问, 或者可以改变项目重心, 与发行商合作发行游戏。
The Steam store is littered with the corpses of self-published indie games that never found a playerbase, and the real tragedy is that many of these titles aren't bad games. They might have found real success if they were better prepared to navigate the challenges of self-publishing or if they had the support of an experienced publisher.	Steam 商店中个人发行失败的独立游戏比比皆是, 毫无玩家群体可言, 而真正的悲哀在于, 其中不乏精良之作。如果这些游戏能够更好地应对个人发行中的挑战, 或者获得经验丰富的发行商的支持, 那么这些游戏可能早已成功了。
Again, this is where the glamor of what indie games appear to be from the outside cloud the realities of the business of games.	然而, 从外界看来, 正是独立游戏的魅力掩盖了游戏业的现实情况。
<i>Gone Home</i> is an iconic indie title from The Fullbright Company and it has the hallmarks of what players have come to expect from indie games. <i>Gone Home</i> is visually compelling with a deep story and the gameplay is a departure from the tropes and cliches of AAA titles. The game itself is wonderful, and the size of the splash it has made since its release in 2013 is so	《到家》(<i>Gone Home</i>) 是 Fullbright 公司开发的一款经典的独立游戏, 它满足了玩家所期待的独立游戏的所有特征。《到家》的故事情节深刻, 视觉上引人入胜, 玩法脱离了 3A 游戏的烂俗套路。这款游戏制作精良, 自 2013 年发行以来, 引起了巨大轰动, 其背后的制作团队功不可没。

substantial that the importance of the team behind the game can be easy to miss.	
Fulbright co-founder Karla Zimonja told Vice that the Fullbright team worked from savings and credit card debt to self-finance <i>Gone Home</i> . Zimonja and the other two Fullbright cofounders, Steve Gaynor and Johnnemann Nordhagen, had worked together at 2K Marin in San Francisco where they worked on <i>Bioshock 2</i> and the <i>Minerva's Den</i> DLC.	Fulbright 有三位联合创始人：卡拉·兹莫尼（Karla Zimonja）、史蒂夫·雷盖纳（Steve Gaynor）以及约翰尼曼·诺德哈根（Johnnemann Nordhagen）。兹莫尼接受 Vice 杂志访谈时表示，团队经历了节衣缩食、信用卡贷款，最终才实现自费开发《到家》。此前，这三位联合创始人已经在美国旧金山与 2K Marin 合作过《生化奇兵 2》（ <i>Bioshock 2</i> ）及其 DLC《密涅瓦巢穴》（ <i>the Minerva's Den</i> ）。
The team rented a house, moved in together, and used the basement as the Fullbright office: “Renting the house together meant we could take a year and a half to make a game and not take out a loan, or go to venture capitalists, not that a venture capitalist would have ever given us money for this,” Zimonja told Vice. Zimonja also said, “But we’re pretty lucky. We had a fall back—if it didn’t work out, we could have gone back to AAA and got jobs again, which isn’t an option that everyone has.”	整个游戏团队一起租房居住，将地下室用作 Fullbright 的办公室： 兹莫尼接受 Vice 采访时说：“一起租房居住意味着有一年半的时间来制作游戏，而且不需要贷款或者找风险投资者，况且风险投资者也不会为这个项目投资。但是非常幸运的是我们有退路，如果这个游戏不成功，还能回去继续制作 3A 游戏，这并不是每个人都有的选择。”
From Zimonja’s story alone, we can already see that <i>Gone Home</i> was a risky project in the minds of the original development team, and the team was also candid about their unique financial and industry advantages. They had the financial	仅仅从兹莫尼的经历，就能够看出《到家》的原始开发团队认为这个项目存在风险，也对自己独特的资金及行业优势直言不讳。因为有资金渠道，才敢赌上 18 个月的时间来开发一款猎奇的独立游戏，再则丰富的 3A

runway to bet 18 months of their lives on a strange indie game, and they had AAA development experience that likely helped them navigate game development and the business of games.	游戏开发经验,可能有助于游戏开发及业务的实现。
Additionally, shortly after the release of <i>Gone Home</i> , co-founder Steve Gaynor launched <i>Tone Control</i> , a games industry podcast that featured guests like Jonathan Blow, Tim Schafer, Ken Levine, Neil Druckmann, and Derek Yu. While <i>Gone Home</i> wasn't the focus of the podcast, Gaynor's connection to the game was a natural part of many of the conversations.	而且,《到家》发行后不久,联合创始人史蒂夫·雷盖纳推出了 <i>Tone Control</i> 节目,这是一个关于游戏行业的播客,主打亮点是邀请著名独立游戏制作人做客访谈,其中包括乔纳生·布洛 (Jonathan Blow)、蒂姆·沙菲尔 (Tim Schafer)、肯·莱文 (Ken Levine)、尼尔·德拉克曼 (Neil Druckmann)、德雷克·于 (Derek Yu)。虽然《到家》并非节目重点,但在谈话过程中提及雷盖纳与游戏的关系,已然屡见不鲜。
<i>Tone Control</i> was immensely popular in its time (bring it back, Steve!), and one can safely assume that its reach helped to extend the momentum of <i>Gone Home</i> as well. The podcast also demonstrates that Gaynor has an incredible network in the industry, hinting at more Fullbright advantages that may not be available to typical indies who haven't worked at AAA studios.	<i>Tone Control</i> 在那个时代广受欢迎 (让它回归,史蒂夫!),可以肯定的是,播客的影响力也提升了《到家》的知名度。播客也体现出雷盖纳的业内人脉资源之广,暗示着 Fullbright 拥有的很多优势,都是其他没有 3A 游戏从业经验的独立游戏制作人所无法企及的。
With that lens, a success story like <i>Gone Home</i> should look very different. Fullbright had funding, experience, and industry access. So, while a game like <i>Gone Home</i> might be a self-publishing success story, make sure you look at the whole story before you decide that self-publishing is	从这个角度而言,像《到家》这样的游戏大获成功的经历是与众不同的。Fullbright 有资金、经验以及行业渠道。因此,虽然《到家》这样的游戏可能是个人发行游戏的成功案例,但是你在决定个人发行项目前,必须确保对其前因后果了然于胸。

right for your project.	
Traditional Publishing	传统发行
Our discussion around self-publishing naturally covered many of the reasons why working with a traditional games' publisher may be right (or wrong) for your project. Funding, marketing, development support, industry access, press relationships, quality assurance – we have talked about all of these variables, as they relate to working with a publisher, already.	讨论个人发行时，本书自然会解释与传统游戏发行商合作对项目的利弊。资金、市场营销、开发支持、行业渠道、媒体关系、品质保证，都是已经讨论过的变量，因为它们关系到与发行商之间的合作。
If you see even one of these gaps in your planning, engaging a publisher should be a serious consideration for your project. If you decide that a publisher is essential to the success of your game, that choice should directly influence your planning process:	如果规划缺少上述某个变量，则要认真考虑项目是否需要与发行商合作。如果认定发行商是游戏成功发行的关键，那么选择与发行商合作会直接影响规划过程：
Here's why: ●Your game and development process need to align with publisher's portfolio ●Finding and pitching publishers are demanding tasks and take ample time ●Publishers often request specific materials from indie studios when they pitch ●Having an attorney review agreements will also require additional budget	原因如下： ●游戏与开发过程要符合发行商的过往项目 ●找到并说服发行商进行投资是耗时的高难度任务 ●发行商往往要求独立游戏工作室在推介游戏时，提供具体材料 ●雇佣律师审查协议也会增加预算
Whether you self-publish or work with a publisher, we recommend that you follow best practices around the whole of the development process, such as working from a well-maintained	无论选择个人发行还是与发行商合作，我们都建议在整个开发过程中遵循最佳实践，如从维护良好的游戏设计文件入手、谨慎管理预算和支出、应用项目管理原则以提升效

GDD, carefully managing budgets and expenses, and applying project management principles to improve efficiency. When you self-publish, though, no one but your own team is looking at the inner workings of your project.	率。然而，选择个人发行后，除了团队成员，没人会关注项目内部的运作情况。
If you sign with a publisher, a third party of experienced game professionals will look at your plans and your processes on an ongoing basis. They start this part during the vetting process to first decide if they want to work with you in the first place, and they do this periodically to ensure that the investment they made in your game is on its way to market as scheduled.	如果与发行商签约合作，会有游戏经验丰富的第三方专业人士持续监督方案与项目进程。在最初的审查阶段，决定是否在项目初期建立合作关系时，他们已然这么做了，之后的定期监督是为了确保自己投资的游戏能如期进入市场。
Therefore, if you don't build your planning and project management to account for this outside set of eyes, you could be creating new obstacles for yourself if you intend to work with a publisher.	因此，如果没有落实好规划与项目管理，对这些外部监督者负责，又打算与发行商合作，开发过程中可能会出现新问题。
In our work as publishers, we see this happen to many indies. Their demo looks great and the pitch sounds exciting, but when we look at their GDD and their budget plans, we uncover big red lags that make us hesitate to commit to the relationship. If an indie is not accurately tracking expenses and is projecting unusual numbers for anticipated costs, then we are usually more critical about investing in the project. In this situation, a publisher often asks themselves, "If the indie isn't careful with their own money, can I	作为发行商，在工作中看到过很多独立游戏制作人陷入上述窘境。他们的试玩版游戏制作精良，游戏推介也令人心动，但游戏设计文档与预算方案却存在巨大隐患，令人对是否建立合作关系犹豫不决。如果独立游戏制作人无法精准追踪支出，并且预期成本数额超出常规，那么通常情况下，发行商对是否投资项目慎之又慎。这种情况下，发行商通常会暗自忖度：“如果独立游戏制作人对自己的资金都随心所欲，我如何能期望他们合理规划投资资金？”

really expect them to be careful with ours?”	
Budgets, development planning, and pitch creation are later topics in this book, so don't fear. We will equip you with tools to keep this from happening to you.	本书后面的主题会涉及预算、开发规划以及推介方案制作，所以不必担心。我们会提供工具，避免此类情况发生。
For now, if you plan to pursue a publisher, here are the tasks and objectives you should incorporate into your planning: ● Create and maintain pitch materials ● Reach out and connect with publishers ● Participation in key showcases and industry events to gain awareness for your title ● Market your game in parallel with your publisher search ● Develop a clear plan for why you need a publisher and how you would use their help and funding ● Create a development roadmap synced to budgets ● Produce a high-quality demo	目前，如果你打算与发行商合作，应该将以下任务和目标整合到规划中： ● 设计并完善推介材料 ● 接触并联系发行商 ● 参加主要的游戏发布会与行业活动，提升游戏知名度 ● 营销游戏与寻找发行商并举 ● 制定方案，清楚说明需要发行商的理由，以及如何使用对方提供的帮助与资金 ● 创建与预算同步的开发路线图 ● 制作高质量试玩版游戏
When you are focused on bringing your game idea to life, many of the items in this list can be easily overlooked. A bad pitch can kill a great game, and actually finding a publisher often takes time and money. Indie budgets are often limited, and as the Fullbright story we just shared illustrated, those budgets are often personally funded, at least in part.	在你专注于实现游戏创意时，很容易忽视上述诸多事项。质量低劣的推介方案足以扼杀一款制作精良的游戏，事实上，寻找发行商常常耗时耗财。独立游戏的预算往往有限，正如上述 Fullbright 的游戏开发经历所表明的那样，通常是开发者自费预算（至少部分如此）。
Many people would struggle to quickly find	聘请律师审查出版协议至少需要 1000 美

\$1,000 (or more) to pay for an attorney to review a publishing agreement. Similarly, the budget to attend a major gaming convention, pay for entry into a networking event at that convention, and also cover booth and travel costs would be difficult to amass with any amount of speed.	元，很多人都难以迅速筹措到这笔资金。同样，以任何速度都难以攒够一大笔预算，用于参加大型游戏展、支付展会中社交活动的入场费、以及展位费和差旅费等。
If you decide in pre-development that your project needs a publisher, your plan should then account for how you are going to find that publisher, allocating all of the time and resources you might need ahead of time so that you have as few surprises as possible to navigate later.	如果在预开发阶段，已经确定项目需要与发行商合作，那么方案应该说明找到发行商的方式，提前合理分配项目可能需要的时间与资源，尽可能减少之后过程中所需要应对的意外情况。
If you identify PAX East as a great place to meet publishers – and it can be – what steps do you need to take to make that happen? Your plan might look like this: ●Complete a polished pitch deck ●Complete a demo build ●Complete a trailer ●Allocate budget for travel, booth rental, and booth materials ●Identify the publishers likely to be in attendance at PAX ●Reach out to publishers one month in advance of PAX ●Reach out to publishers one week in advance in PAX ●Reach out to publishers on day one of PAX to catch last-minute meetings	如果认为 PAX East 展会是认识发行商的绝佳之处（它确实是），那么为了实现这一目标，需要采取哪些措施呢？ 方案可能包括以下内容： ●优化并完成推介文档 ●完成试玩版游戏构建 ●完成预告片 ●分配差旅、展位租赁、展位材料的预算 ●确认可能出席 PAX 展会的发行商 ●PAX 展会前一个月接触发行商 ●PAX 展会前一周接触发行商 ●PAX 展会第一天接触发行商，争取进行临时会议 ●如果条件允许，获取 PAX 展会媒体名单 ●规划展位覆盖度，确保个人（或商务拓展主管）参加会议时，展位不会无人看顾 ●利用日程的闲暇时光，主动拜访发行商展

●Reach out to the PAX press list when it is available ●Plan for booth coverage so that you (or your business development lead) can take meetings without leaving your booth unattended ●Fill the gaps in your schedule with “cold knocking” publisher booths to pitch your game ●Follow up with the people you met each evening as appropriate (giving them access to your deck and demo, for example) ●Follow up with everyone who replied to your emails after the event, whether you had a meeting or not	位并向其推介游戏 ●每晚适当跟进结识的发行商（例如，向他们提供推介文档与试玩版游戏） ●无论是否有过面谈，跟进在展会后回复邮件的每个人
Fully preparing for an event like PAX can absorb a month of development time for some developers because every item we listed above ripples through the whole of the project. If you want to have a complete pitch deck and a shareable demo, your team will need to meet specific development milestones to bring those items to life. And then you need to devote time to creating event materials, including posters and displays for your booth, and you also need to set aside time for managing your outreach and pitches.	因为上述任一事项都足以对整个项目产生涟漪效应，所以一些开发者会牺牲一个月的开发时间，为 PAX 这样的活动做足准备。如果打算在活动前制作出完整的推介文档与可分享的试玩版游戏，团队需要满足具体的开发里程碑，才能将上述事项付诸于现实。然后，需要投入大量时间制作活动材料，包括展位海报与展位布置，还要预留时间来管理外展服务和项目推介。
Even if you elbow grease your way through many of these tasks, the event will still cost you money. If those costs are not well managed, the drain on your budget could threaten the project as a whole.	即使费尽心思完成了上述诸多任务，仍然需要考虑活动中的其他花销。如果无法妥善管理这些活动成本，预算透支可能会危及整个项目。

Fortunately, indie-friendly industry hacks exist. Organizations such as Indie MEGABOOTH have done a great deal to make major gaming events accessible to new indies, and initiatives like PAX Rising do the same. There is also a shifting landscape of contests, scholarships, and grants available to indies that can defray expenses, give you extra help, and put you in front of publishers.	幸好，游戏业对独立游戏制作人十分友好，让其能够获得一些帮助。如 Indie MEGABOOTH 与 PAX Rising 之类的组织与活动，一直致力于帮助新手独立游戏制作人参加各大业内活动。此前独立游戏制作人能够通过参加比赛、获得奖学金与补助的方式贴补开支，这些途径能让独立游戏制作人获得额外帮助，还能由此引荐给发行商，但今时不同往日。
We recognize that opportunities like access to industry events require a certain amount of privilege. Not everyone has the funds to go to events or lives reasonably close to a major event to make it remotely practical. You can still find a publisher without the benefits of attending an in-person event, but again, your plan needs to account for this obstacle earlier rather than later. In this kind of scenario, you may need to spend more time on cold outreach, participating in digital networking opportunities, and drumming up organic interest in your work to get a publisher's attention.	我们意识到，需要一定的特权才有机会参加这样的行业活动。并非人人都能够让梦想照进现实，有足够的资金预算参加这些行业活动，或者有地理优势，在大型活动举办地附近。即使无法亲自参加这些活动，错失其附带的天然优势，仍有机会找到发行商，但是话说回来，方案需要考虑无法参展的问题，宜早不宜晚。在这种情况下，可能需要花更多时间主动联系业内人士、参与数字社交活动、激发发行商对作品的兴趣从而获得青睐。
Snoozy Kazoo and Robi Studios are both examples of how different indie paths – but good planning – can set your game up for publishing success. Disclaimer: We worked with both of these teams via Graffiti Games, so our adoration is rooted in a very clear bias for their work, but	Snoozy Kazoo 与 Robi Studio 的经历足以说明，拥有细致谨慎的规划，即使独立游戏发行路径截然不同，游戏发行仍可大获成功。免责声明：我们通过 Graffiti Games 与这两个工作室都有过合作，所以十分偏爱他们开发的 game，纵然是其游戏的头号粉丝，但在

we believe their stories are relevant here even if we fanboy over their games.	此分享工作室的经历只因其本身值得借鉴参考。
Snoozy Kazoo is the team behind <i>Turnip Boy Commits Tax Evasion</i> . This comical pixel art action adventure game began as a small hobby project that the team showcased at a BostonFIG event. If you aren't familiar, BostonFIG is a nonprofit whose mission is to "support and showcase the efforts of independent game developers, as well nurture young aspiring game creators from diverse backgrounds."	Snoozy Kazoo 开发制作的《大头菜小子避税历险记》(<i>Turnip Boy Commits Tax Evasion</i>), 是一款妙趣横生的像素风休闲益智游戏, 雏形是该团队在 BostonFIG 活动上展示的一个小型兴趣项目。如果还不熟悉 BostonFIG, 稍微介绍一下: 这是一个非盈利活动, 旨在“支持并展示独立游戏制作人的成果, 也培养不同背景的有抱负的游戏创作者。”
For Snoozy Kazoo, BostonFIG was an accessible starting point for sharing <i>Turnip Boy</i> with players. The overwhelming love for the game-jam version of <i>Turnip Boy</i> surprised the development team and made them decide to expand the scope and vision for what the game could be. The team went back into development and set their sights on showcasing at PAX East, which they were able to have a small booth at as a result of winning the Mass Digi Challenge.	Snoozy Kazoo 以 BostonFIG 为起点, 将《大头菜小子》带进玩家视野。玩家狂热追捧这款限时开发游戏, 开发团队受宠若惊, 于是决定扩大原本的游戏范围与愿景。该团队继续开发该款游戏, 计划在 PAX East 展会上亮相成果。由于在 Mass Digi Challenge 比赛中获胜, 他们在该展会中拥有了一席之地。
And that's where we met Snoozy Kazoo. One of our booth workers knew the Snoozy team and told us to check out their game of a turnip committing tax fraud and challenging a corrupt vegetable government. The premise was intriguing, and sure enough, as more of our team members found time to check out the booth, the more excited we were to have a conversation with	我们正是在这个展会与 Snoozy Kazoo 不期而遇。展位的一名工作人员知道这个团队, 安利大家了解该团队开发的游戏: 一个大头菜小子逃税, 还挑战腐败的蔬菜政府。这个设定引人入胜, 果不其然, 随着抽时间拜访 Snoozy Kazoo 展位的员工数量不断增加, 同这个团队之间的交流就令人愈加兴奋。

this indie team.	
A year later, <i>Turnip Boy Commits Tax Evasion</i> became a true indie success story.	一年后，《大头菜小子避税历险记》果真大获成功了。
The path to publishing for Robi Studios' <i>Blue Fire</i> was much different, however. Robi Studios is based in Argentina, so unlike Snoozy Kazoo, they are not right down the street from events like BostonFIG or PAX East. Their path to connecting with Graffiti Games focused more on building their online presence. They posted some great GIFs and images to their Twitter page, which made us contact them to see if they were interested in a publisher.	然而，Robi Studios 选择了迥然不同的方式发行《蓝色火焰》(<i>Blue Fire</i>)。该工作室的总部位于阿根廷，所以不像 Snoozy Kazoo 那样有地理优势，无法参加 BostonFIG 或 PAX East 之类的游戏展会。该工作室专注于扩大自己的网络影响力，获得 Graffiti Games 的青睐后，与之建立合作关系。他们在自己的推特主页上发布了一些超棒的 GIF 及图像，这促使我们主动伸出橄榄枝，以确定其与发行商的合作意向。
Once we connected, we worked with the Robi Studios team in much the same way as we worked with Snoozy Kazoo because all of the games published by Graffiti come from studios around the world. <i>Blue Fire</i> , like <i>Turnip Boy</i> , did very well at launch and beyond.	因为 Graffiti 所发行的游戏都出自工作室的手笔，这些团队遍布全球各地，一旦同它们建立合作关系，合作的方式都大同小异，所以这两个团队也不例外。《蓝色火焰》与《大头菜小子》一样，成功发行并造成轰动。
In practice, we were looking for the same signals even though both of these stories are about very different games and from developers from very different backgrounds: a game that was interesting to us, a game that had marketability, and a team that we trusted to deliver on their promises. They might have come in through different doors, but they ultimately checked the same boxes.	事实上，虽然这两个工作室制作的游戏迥异，开发者的背景也大相径庭，却能在其经历中发现相似之处：游戏本身趣味盎然、颇具市场潜力，并且都拥有令人信服能够实现承诺的游戏团队。虽然选择的发行方式有所不同，但是最终都推动游戏成功发行。
For Snoozy Kazoo, we could see players reacting	从 Snoozy Kazoo 的经历中可以得知，在

to the game in real time at PAX, and we had a similar reaction when we played it for ourselves. As we talked to the team themselves, they were professional and prepared despite <i>Turnip Boy</i> being their first full game. They had clearly done their homework and did everything they could to be ready to pitch their game if they had the chance.	PAX 展会上能够看到玩家对于游戏的实时反应，而且自己玩游戏时也有类似反应。同这个团队沟通时，我们发现尽管《大头菜小子》是该团队的第一个完整版游戏，他们却非常专业且准备充足。他们显然做足了功课，只要有机会，就竭尽所能推介游戏。
For Robi Studios, we couldn't see players reacting to the game, but knew what they were presenting would have interest from a large audience. When we played the demo, our excitement grew. And then when we talked with the Robi team, they too were professional and prepared.	从 Robi Studios 的经历中，虽然无法看到玩家对于游戏的反应，可以笃定的是，游戏呈现的内容能够引起广大玩家的兴趣。在该游戏的试玩过程中，人们往往愈发兴奋。随后与 Robi Studios 沟通时，我们发现这个团队也同样专业且准备充足。
We should emphasize that neither Snoozy Kazoo or Robi Studios knew the answer to every one of our questions or had absolutely pristine pitch decks or complete knowledge of the games industry. No reasonable publisher expects a seasoned indie studio to be perfect, and they definitely don't expect a new indie studio to know everything there is to know about making and releasing an indie game.	需要强调的是，无论是 Snoozy Kazoo 还是 Robi Studios，对于每一个问题的答案绝非面面俱到，推介文档做不到绝对原创，对游戏行业也并非了如指掌。理智的发行商不会要求经验丰富的独立游戏工作室尽善尽美，当然也不会期待新手独立游戏工作室对独立游戏制作及发行过程中的事无巨细全然了解。
However, a publisher does want to see that even a brand new indie team is being thoughtful about the choices they make, are doing everything in their power to anticipate and solve problems, and is using the resources they do have in an effective	然而，发行商确实希望看到，即使是全新的独立游戏制作团队，在作选择时能够深思熟虑、竭尽所能预测并解决问题、并且高效利用手中的资源。

way.	
Publishers can tell when a pitch deck was made the night before or if a budget is based on imaginary numbers, so it says a lot about an indie to see that they are putting significant effort into planning from the beginning.	如果推介文档是前一天晚上赶工而成,或预算数据基于想象而成,发行商是能够分辨出来的,因此发行商能轻而易举判断出,独立游戏制作人是否从一开始就在规划中倾注心血。
Crowdfunded Projects	众筹项目
In Chapter 1, we mentioned that finding indie game success with crowdfunding is a very specific path that justifies a book-length explanation on that strategy alone. While we don't have the page count to fully explore crowdfunding in this book, we should address how the decision to crowdfund your game can affect your planning.	第一章提过利用众筹推动独立游戏成功发行是一种非常特殊的方式,足以用一本书的篇幅来解释这一策略。虽然本书没有足够篇幅充分探讨众筹,但是会阐述选择众筹作为游戏发行方式将如何影响项目规划。
Crowdfunding could be your path to self-publishing or it could be your path to attracting a publisher. Because a great crowdfunding campaign has many of the same hallmarks as an actual launch in terms of the noise you need to make and the level of polish that backers have come to expect from promotional materials, putting your game on Kickstarter or Indiegogo is a strategic business choice, a marketing moment, a funding tool, and a revenue channel all in one.	无论是个人发行游戏,还是与发行商合作发行游戏,都可以选择众筹游戏。因为大型众筹项目与实际发行有诸多相似之处,如需要为项目造势、需要将游戏不断优化至宣传材料所描绘的样子,以满足赞助人的期待,将游戏放上 Kickstarter 或 Indiegogo 是集策略性商业选择、营销时机、融资工具及营收渠道为一体的手段。
Many publishers use Kickstarter as a scouting tool. If a developer is able to hit a crowdfunding goal independently, that says a great amount	许多发行商利用 Kickstarter 来挑选项目。如果开发者能够独立完成众筹目标,且玩家愿意充分支持游戏的正式发行,这说明玩家对

about what the appetite for a game might be if the official launch was fully supported.	这款游戏兴趣极大。
If a project does really well with crowdfunding and has a great team behind it, the game might have all of the talent and treasure it needs to self-publish.	如果项目众筹大获成功，幕后团队出类拔萃，那么该游戏可能拥有个人发行所需要的一切人才和资源。
Crowdfunding is incredible, and the popularity of crowdfunding has been a major boon to indie games of all shapes and sizes, but this path is not without risks. Despite the efforts of Kickstarter and Indiegogo to educate campaign organizers on best practices, many aspiring indies still think of crowdfunding as “easy money.” Make a campaign, make some big promises, sprinkle in great art, and voila, you have a few hundred thousand dollars to build your dream game.	众筹无疑大有裨益，随着其普及度不断增加，各个类型及规模的独立游戏都受益匪浅，但这种方式也并非万无一失。尽管 Kickstarter 和 Indiegogo 努力向众筹项目发起人传授最佳实践经验，但是很多有志向的独立游戏制作人仍将众筹看作“不义之财”。发起一场众筹活动、作出一些重大承诺、再用伟大艺术包装一下，瞧，就能拥有几十万美元来打造理想的游戏。
That’s, of course, not how it actually works, but enough indies are still making this mistake that we feel we need to address the business implications here.	当然，事实并非如此，但持这种偏见的独立游戏制作人仍不在少数，所以在此有必要解释清楚众筹隐含的问题。
Beyond the lift of running a great crowdfunding campaign, you should also consider the following: ●It can take one to two months to put together a successful Kickstarter campaign ●The first crowdfunding campaign from a developer is rarely a runaway success, especially if the developer is unknown ●A failed crowdfunding campaign can send	除了提升大型众筹项目的运营能力以外，也应该考虑以下事项： ●成功的 Kickstarter 众筹项目需要一至两个月的时间 ●开发者的首个众筹项目罕有大获成功的，尤其在开发者寂寂无名时 ●失败的众筹项目会向潜在的投资人和发行商传递负面信号 ●对赞助人毁诺会成为职业生涯永久的污

negative signals to potential investors and publishers ●Breaking promises to backers can permanently harm your reputation in the industry ●Fully accounting for development and perk fulfillment costs is especially challenging for inexperienced indies, so you can reach your goal and still discover you don't have enough budget ●Stretch goals can significantly shift development scope and player experience, which can be difficult to manage post-campaign ●Backers expect regular, meaty updates post-campaign ●Any significant pivot in the game's trajectory that was not addressed in the original campaign can create big community problems (such as signing with a publisher post-campaign)	点 ●毫无经验的独立游戏制作人想要充分说明开发成本与福利实现成本,十分具有挑战性,所以可能在实现众筹目标后,仍然发现预算不够 ●扩大目标会显著改变开发范围与玩家体验,这在众筹之后难以管理 ●众筹之后,赞助人期待规律、内容丰富的更新 ●任何游戏规划过程中的重大问题,如果未能在初始众筹项目中得以解决,都会为社区带来巨大的蝴蝶效应(如众筹之后与发行商签约合作)
If you opt to pursue crowdfunding, you should address each of these points in your plan. Depending on your industry experience, you might consider building a small but respectable social media following first and then running a small crowdfunding campaign for a smaller project. For all of the amazing guides and resources out there, learning the ins and outs of running a crowdfunding campaign is largely done from doing one yourself.	如果选择众筹,就应该在方案中解决上述各个事项。根据个人从业经验,可以考虑创建一个小型却有价值的社交媒体,先关注其运营状况,然后再为规模较小的项目发起小型众筹。尽管众筹的指导及资源储量丰富,但想习得众筹项目的运营能力,把握整个过程的来龙去脉,多半还得靠亲自操作才能实现。
If your first campaign is on the smaller side, you will need less fanfare to reach your initial goal	如果第一个众筹规模较小,实现初始目标所需要的宣传力度更小,同时也给自己更大的

while also giving yourself more room to make mistakes that are not catastrophic. For example, misjudging the cost of producing and fulfilling t-shirts for a \$4,000 crowdfunding campaign is not as bad as making the same mistake for a \$250,000 campaign. Additionally, having successful campaigns tied to your account builds trust, making it more likely for users to believe that you can deliver on your bigger promises when you start making them.	空间来试错,只要不是灾难性的错误。例如,错误判断T恤的制作及生产成本,发起价值4000美元的众筹项目所带来的后果,不如犯同样的错误后发起价值25万美元的众筹项目所带来的后果严重。此外,账户上拥有众筹成功的记录,能够提升账户的可信度,在许下雄心壮志时,更能让玩家相信这些诺言能够付诸于现实。
You don't always need to build slowly. It is possible for your game to be a breakout crowdfunding hit, but a good business plan does not rely on being the exception to industry norms. Be reasonable, but also have a plan for how you will capitalize on great coverage and big interest if it comes.	并不需要一直缓慢推进项目。游戏可能成为众筹热门项目,但是好的商业方案并不意味着打破行业常规。要保持理智,众筹大获成功后,也要制定方案说明如何利用随之而来的广泛报道与巨大利益。
Earlier, we talked about how Sabotage Studios ran an elegant Kickstarter for their game <i>Sea of Stars</i>. A great team with a fantastic track record of finding crowdfunding success is not all that surprising. While we can learn a lot from how they approached crowdfunding, many of our readers are unlikely to have the resources and clout that Sabotage Studios had at the beginning of their campaign.	此前,探讨过 Sabotage Studios 在 Kickstarter 上为其游戏《星海》(<i>Sea of Stars</i>) 成功实现众筹的方式。一个优秀的团队拥有诸多出色的众筹成功案例,实属意料之中。虽然他们的众筹成功经验令人受益匪浅,但是很多读者不太可能如同 Sabotage Studios 那样,在众筹初期就拥有优渥的资源与深远的影响力。
Let's look at a different game that might be familiar: <i>Undertale</i>. Today, this indie title from developer Toby Fox is in the pantheon of	接下来介绍另一款游戏,也许已为大众所熟知:《地下传说》(<i>Undertale</i>)。现今,这款由托比·福克斯(Toby Fox)开发的游戏已经

legendary indie success stories, but <i>Undertale</i> actually began from a humble beginning in crowdfunding.	跻身于成功的独立游戏传奇之列,但其实溯其本源也不过是小型众筹项目。
For the millions of units <i>Undertale</i> has sold to date, Fox first launched his Kickstarter with a \$5,000 goal in 2013. Yes, crowdfunding has changed significantly in the nearly 10 years since the <i>Undertale</i> campaign went live, but Fox's initial goal is still worth highlighting because it shows how far small decisions can carry a project.	迄今为止,《地下传说》销量已达百万,这是福克斯于 2013 年发起的第一个 Kickstarter 众筹项目,其目标不过 5000 美元。的确,在《地下传说》众筹上线以来的近 10 年里,众筹已经发生了剧变,但仍有必要强调福克斯的初始目标,因为这体现出一个小小的决定能够推动项目发展到何种难以企及的高度。
With a goal of \$5,000 and a unique premise for a game, Fox's campaign gained momentum. That manageable goal likely made it easier for early backers to participate because a lower goal meant a higher likelihood for success, and the game Fox pitched to go along with the budget felt like it matched that scope to a reasonable degree. He was not promising an expansive 3D MMO for a small budget but rather a polished, concise pixel art indie game – the kind of scope solo indies have tackled many times before.	凭借 5000 美元的目标与独特的游戏设定,福克斯的众筹项目获得了发展动力。因为目标较低意味着成功的可能性更大,这个易管理的目标可能让早期赞助人更容易参与其中,福克斯推介游戏所筹措的预算似乎能够合理完成项目的范围。他并没有承诺用这一小笔预算制作昂贵的 3D MMO 游戏,而是选择制作了像素风独立游戏,既精心打磨又简洁明了。此前独立游戏制作人已经多次开发过这种规模的游戏。
And users could try the demo before making a pledge, which turned out to be a critical element as word of the game spread. Prospective players could experience the promises Fox was making about the <i>Undertale</i> paradigm, making it real rather than another empty Kickstarter promise.	在决定参与众筹之前,用户可以体验试玩版游戏,这是推动游戏传播的关键因素。潜在玩家可以从试玩版中感受到福克斯许诺的正式版《地下传说》,明白他有能力将众筹项目付诸现实,而并非 Kickstarter 网站上的又一个空头承诺。
In sum, 2,398 backers supported the campaign,	总计有 2398 名赞助人支持福克斯的众筹项

raising a total of \$51,124. Five years after its 2015 release, NPR reported that <i>Undertale</i> had sold “millions of copies.” We can also reasonably assume that <i>Undertale</i> merchandise has done exceptionally well under the stewardship of Fangamer, the merchandise company that has the exclusive <i>Undertale</i> rights at the time of this writing.	目，众筹金额总计 51124 美元。《地下传说》于 2015 年发行，五年之后，美国国家广播电视台(NPR)报道称该游戏销量已达百万。因为在本文撰写时，游戏周边公司 Fangamer 拥有该游戏的独家授权，可以合理地假设，在该公司的管理之下，《地下传说》的游戏周边产品也十分畅销。
Millions of units is far from a moderately successful crowdfunding campaign with less than 3,000 backers, and that’s one of the lessons hidden in the Fox story: A big success came from a manageable development budget and a relatively small crowdfunding goal not only because the game was good but because Fox kept building momentum for his work one piece at a time.	赞助人不足三千人的众筹项目即便成功，也无法企及数百万销量，福克斯的经历所体现的经验之一：巨大的成功源自易管理的开发预算与相对较小的众筹目标，不仅因为游戏精良，而且福克斯一直在为游戏蓄力，每次只专注一个游戏。
The <i>Undertale</i> campaign has 39 total updates with the last update coming in 2017 (two years after the game’s official release). Fox stayed active with marketing and community communication up to and through the release of the game, which included consistent posts to his Tumblr blog as well.	《地下传说》众筹项目共计更新 39 次，最后一次是在 2017 年（游戏正式发行两年之后）。在游戏发行前与发行期间，福克斯一直积极参与市场营销与社区交流，也包括在汤博乐（Tumblr）博客上持续发帖。
In one of those blogs, Fox wrote, “Though I did work hard, there’s definitely a lot of luck involved in having a game become this popular.”	福克斯在其中一篇博客中写道：“尽管我确实呕心沥血地制作游戏，但是它如今能够风靡全球，其中定然也包含了运气成分。”
Luck may have been a factor for Fox, but the	可能运气确实是福克斯成功的一个因素，但

game's trajectory in hindsight is a series of well-tempered decisions from an indie developer, and those choices put <i>Undertale</i> in position to capitalize on the attention it garnered.	是其游戏规划中包含了一系列他对游戏深思熟虑的选择,正是这些选择让《地下传说》有机会充分利用自身获得的关注。
The larger takeaway for indies, whether they plan to self-publish or to use crowdfunding to attract a publisher as well, is that crowdfunding success is not always about big upfront dollars.	无论独立游戏制作人打算个人发行游戏还是利用众筹吸引发行商合作发行游戏,众筹成功并不一定意味着大笔预付款,了解这一点尤为重要。
A "Living" Document	“活”文件
We have several other planning considerations to cover yet, but this overview of potential project types and goals should already have you thinking about what steps may be best suited for bringing your game to market. That said, the benefit of a thorough planning process is that you can revise and adjust course with relatively little pain.	规划阶段中还有几个注意事项尚未探讨,但是这部分关于潜在项目类型及目标的概述,应该能够引发读者思考,采取何种措施最能推动游戏成功发行。也就是说,制定一份详细的规划,有助于轻而易举地修改及调整项目过程。
As we talk about market evaluations, scoping your game, and selecting an engine to work in, your previous choices may warrant an adjustment. Where you thought you needed a publisher, you might realize that self-publishing is a better fit because of how your game fits into its target genre.	由于已经讨论过市场评估、游戏范围确定、游戏引擎选择等主题,所以之前作出的相关选择可能需要进行一些调整。也许原本认为需要与发行商合作发行游戏,可是随后意识到游戏更适合个人发行,因为游戏与目标类型完美契合。
Planning is not a linear process. Everything is written in pencil at this point, and you are supposed to go back and make adjustments as new information comes to your attention. A plan is a living document, which means that it changes, expands, and grows over time. It is not a	规划并非线性过程,当前阶段的所有内容都需要用文字记录下来,在获得新信息后应该对此进行回顾并做出相应调整。方案应该是“活”文件,这意味着方案会随时间变化、扩大、发展。制定的方案并非一成不变的固定内容。

fixed piece of output that you make and never change.	
Take notes. Write down questions. Imagine a variety of scenarios. Keep challenging yourself to make your plan better as you continue reading.	过程中，需要记笔记、记录问题、预测各种情况。在阅读后面内容时，不断挑战自我方能促进方案完善。
Chapter Six Genre and Market Evaluation	第六章 类型及市场评估
In this chapter, we start to step through core considerations in planning the development for your game. This process has several goals, all of which can impact your overall success. Those goals are as follows: 1. Create a predictable and practical development schedule by clearly outlining what you need to make to complete your game. 2. Develop the assets and materials that are likely to be relevant to investors and publishers. 3. Map your plan to a real budget so you can understand the resources your project needs to set. Wishlist goals as well as sales goals.	本章将开始讨论游戏规划开发阶段中的核心考量。此过程中的几个目标都足以影响整个项目的成功与否，目标如下： 1. 通过清晰列出游戏制作所需落实的事项，制定兼具预测性与实用性的开发进度表 2. 开发投资者与发行商看重的游戏资源与素材 3. 将方案同实际预算相结合，便于了解项目设定愿望单及销售目标所需资源
No development plan is perfect. The games industry has a long history of delayed releases, mismanaged player expectations, and cancelled projects. The biggest studios in the world struggle to manage timelines and budgets, so much so that “don’t preorder!” has become a meme in the community. If the most experienced people in the industry find this difficult, what hope does an indie have for getting it right?	不存在无懈可击的开发方案。游戏业中发行延期、玩家预期管理不足、项目取消等问题遭人诟病已久。全球规模最大的游戏工作室都在努力管理时间线与预算，以至于“不要预定！”俨然成了游戏社区的新梗。如果最有经验的业界人士都难以妥善管理时间线与预算，独立游戏制作人又何来希望呢？
What we are really aiming to do here is to reduce	此处真正的目的是降低规划阶段中错误的

the severity of planning mistakes. If a AAA team misjudges their release by six months or more, an inexperienced developer can easily miss the mark by a year or more. A delay of that length for a multi-million-dollar game might be painful, but those scale of studios have access to capital and cash reserves in most cases.	严重性。如果 3A 游戏团队对发行时间的判断误差达到 6 个月或以上,那么缺乏经验的开发者的判断误差可能是 1 年或以上。一款价值数百万美元的游戏,发行时间延长如此之久,其所受损失难以估量,但是在多数情况下,成规模的游戏工作室储备了足够的资本与资金。
Adding a year of budget to an indie game is a death sentence for most indies. You will rarely hit your development milestones and your budgets precisely as planned, but you should make every effort possible to get as close as you can with your planning so that you can be in a better position to absorb potential problems.	独立游戏增加一年的预算能将多数独立游戏制作人逼入绝境。虽然无法按照规划一般精准落实开发里程碑与预算,但却应该竭尽所能提高规划完成度,以便更好地解决潜在问题。
Asking your publisher for an extra month of development time or taking out a loan to cover payroll for that month is not ideal, but it's not catastrophic. You will still be close to your target launch window, and the relative small amount of additional budget you need could be addressed in several ways.	无论是向发行商征求同意延长一个月的开发时间,还是贷款支付当月的工资,均非理想做法,但也并非灾难性问题。这样的做法能够让项目仍然接近目标发行窗口,而且所需追加的预算数额较小,也能通过几种办法筹措到足够资金。
Missing the mark by several months, on the other hand, puts your game in an entirely new launch window, which could be outright impossible for your publisher to accommodate because of their other planned launches, and your humble indie game may end up releasing at the same time as the next hot AAA title, putting you at a severe marketing disadvantage.	另一方面,游戏发行延迟数月,会让游戏进入了全新的发行窗口,这意味着发行商可能因为其他计划发行的游戏完全无法适应这一情况,因此这款游戏可能最终会与下一款热门的 3A 游戏撞期,这将导致游戏在市场营销上处于极度劣势地位。

With our process, you can eliminate many of the most common problems that indies face before they actually become problems, and that means deep forethought for the following: ●Your target market ●Game scope (length, complexity, post-launch updates or DLC) ●Engine selection ●Translation and localization ●Development and release timelines ●Building a team ●Mapping your plan to a budget	通过这部分内容,能够将多数独立游戏制作人最常遇到的许多问题扼杀在摇篮里,这意味着深入思考以下内容: ●目标市场 ●游戏范围(游戏时长、复杂度、发行后的更新或 DLC) ●引擎选择 ●翻译与本地化 ●开发及发行时间线 ●组建团队 ●结合方案与预算
Even if you already have an idea for what kind of game you want to make, all your development choices will be more impactful if you can clearly see where your game fits into your chosen genre, so let's start there.	即使已经确定了即将制作的游戏类型,如果能了解游戏与选定类型的适配之处,那么开发阶段的所有选择都将更为有效,所以从此处入手。
Predicting Sales Success	预测销售成功
If one of the goals for your game is to find financial success, your planning process should answer the question, "How do I know players will buy my game?"	如果游戏的目标之一是实现经济收益,在规划过程中应该回答这个问题:“我如何确定玩家会购买这款游戏?”
The answer to this question has implications for every layer of your project, from the features you choose to include to the target development budget to how you market the finished product. Beyond how you and your team will directly leverage that answer, publishers and investors are likely to ask about this reasoning as well. They	这个问题的答案会影响项目的方方面面,从项目包含的特点、目标开发预算到营销游戏的方式。除了个人与团队将直接利用这个答案之外,发行商与投资者可能也会询问开发者关于这类问题的思考。他们也想知道自己支持的项目能否成功,希望在自己分析的同时听到开发者的推理。

too want to know if the project they support will be successful, and they will expect to hear your reasoning as they do their own analysis.	
No business is a purely scientific endeavor. Yes, we want to rely on data and quantifiable trends as much as we can, but doing something different will always mean venturing into the unknown to some degree. You can make all the best decisions on paper and still not accurately predict the outcome.	商业并非单纯的研发。的确,我们希望尽可能依靠数据与量化趋势,但是依靠其他工具在某种程度上意味着对未知的探索。即使在理论上能够作出最佳选择,也仍然无法精准预测结果。
The art of business is using a combination of savvy and creativity to fill in the gaps with an educated guess. No matter how smart we are and how much we think we know, we can never know for certain if a product is going to be a success or not.	商业艺术是指凭借有根据的猜测,结合实际情况与创造力来填补空白。无论一个人多么聪明,自认知识储备多么丰富,也永远无法确定一个产品成功与否。
In the games industry, we often see indies drift to the extremes of this spectrum. Some indies totally ignore the parts of their project that they can quantify—such as the Wishlist math we explored in Part 1—and put the entirety of their trust in their own creativity. If they are passionate about their game, they assume that the passion they feel will be shared equally by anyone else who plays the game.	在游戏业,时常能够发现独立游戏制作人走向这种极端。一些独立游戏制作人完全忽视了项目中可量化的部分,如第一部分探讨的愿望单数学,全然信赖自己的创造力。如果自己能从游戏中感受到激情,就假设任何玩这款游戏的人都能感同身受。
At the other extreme, some indies observe a trend in game sales or player preferences and overestimate the implications of that data. If <i>Among Us</i> is the most popular game of the	另一个极端是一些独立游戏制作人观察游戏销量趋势或玩家偏好趋势,却高估了这些数据所能产生的影响。如果《在我们之间》(<i>Among Us</i>)是当下最流行的游戏,他们

moment, they assume that if they make a game that shares the mechanics and features of <i>Among Us</i> , they will also be successful.	会假设,如果制作的游戏拥有相同的机制与特点,自己也定然能够功成名就。
When we simplify those perspectives to these two extremes, the flaws in the logic of either of these assumptions is likely clear. Of course you can't assume that your personal tastes match the tastes of your target playerbase. Of course you can't expect to be financially successful by ripping off the premise of an already popular game (something that is all too common). Yet, we see indies fall into these traps over and over and over again.	将这些观点简化为上述两个极端事例后,任一假设的逻辑漏洞也就清晰可见了。显然,不能假设目标受众的品味与开发者个人的品味全然一致。当然,通过抄袭已然流行的某个游戏设定(这已司空见惯),不能指望财源滚滚。然而,独立游戏制作人一再重蹈覆辙已屡见不鲜。
To find the reasonable middle ground, here is the data you need to explore: ●Sales trends for titles in your target genre ●Broader sales trends for the industry ●Metacritic and Steam review data for comparable titles ●Publically available data on social media engagement around comparable titles ●Other market signals that could be impact the performance of your project	要想达到合理的平衡,就需要了解以下数据: ●目标类型游戏的销售趋势 ●游戏行业更广泛的销售趋势 ●Metacritic 和 Steam 上同类游戏的评价 ●同类游戏社交媒体参与度的公开数据 ●其他可能影响项目业绩的市场信号
The term in this list that might be new to you is “comparable titles.” A comparable title is any game that might share your target audience, either in whole or in part. No two games are exactly alike, but a player that likes the action of <i>The Binding of Isaac</i> might also like <i>Enter the</i>	在上述内容中,读者可能对“同类游戏”这一术语稍有陌生。同类游戏是指任何可能部分或者全部共享目标受众的游戏。不存在如出一辙的两个游戏,但是喜欢《以撒的结合》动作冒险的玩家,可能也会喜欢《挺进地牢》(<i>Enter the Gungeon</i>)。这两款游戏有很多相

<i>Gungeon</i>. They have enough in common that if you were also making a twin-stick Roguelite dungeon crawler, you could learn a great deal from these two games. Usually your comparable titles are the games that inspired yours or that you reference in your messaging of the game. For instance, we compared <i>Blue Fire</i> to <i>A Hat in Time</i> and <i>The Legend of Zelda: The Wind Waker</i> due to its 3D platforming RPG adventure mechanics.	同之处，如果你也正在制作一款双摇杆 Roguelite 地牢探险者游戏，能从上述两款游戏中受益良多。通常，同类游戏是指激发游戏灵感或在游戏介绍中提到的游戏。例如，因为都拥有 3D 平台化 RPG 冒险机制，《蓝色火焰》(<i>Blue Fire</i>)、《时光之帽》(<i>A Hat in Time</i>) 和《塞尔达传说：风之杖》(<i>The Legend of Zelda: The Wind Waker</i>) 可以归为同类游戏。
Discussions around comparable titles and target genres often happen simultaneously, but distinguishing between the two is important for both your planning process and for how you talk about your game to publishers, media, streamers, and potential players.	通常是同时讨论同类游戏与目标类型，但是在规划过程中，在向发行商、媒体、游戏主播以及潜在玩家介绍游戏时，区分同类游戏与目标类型至关重要。
Genre definitions can be controversial, so while your game might broadly qualify as a platformer, finding titles that are more similar within the genre can help you benchmark player interest and also better communicate your vision for your game (if it is still in development).	游戏类型定义可能存在争议，尽管游戏可能大致符合平台游戏的定义，但在同类型中找到更为类似的游戏，有助于了解玩家的兴趣，也能更好地表达游戏愿景（如果游戏还处于开发阶段）。
Your platformer might more closely resemble <i>Celeste</i> than it does <i>Hollow Knight</i>, and that's a big distinction because of how players perceive those titles. The game-play of <i>Celeste</i> focuses intensely on contained challenges. The layout of a level is in itself a puzzle, and each level is separated from the others by very clear checkpoints. In <i>Hollow Knight</i>, on the other hand,	相较于《空洞骑士》(<i>Hollow Knight</i>)，你的平台游戏可能与《蔚蓝》(<i>Celeste</i>) 的相似度更高，由于玩家对游戏的理解方式不同，所以这种对类似度的判定结果大相径庭。《蔚蓝》的玩法主要是通关游戏设定的关卡，其布局本身就是一个谜题，通过明确的通关条件，各个关卡之间相互独立。另一方面，平台游戏《空洞骑士》的玩法也是关于

the platforming is also about solving challenges, but it is also a vehicle for exploring a vast branching world, the kind of experience that <i>Metroidvania</i> fans crave.	通关挑战,但在游戏过程中玩家也能探索分支剧情,这是《银河恶魔城》(<i>Metroidvania</i>)的玩家一直渴望的游戏体验。
Even if your game is not exactly like <i>Celeste</i> – and it shouldn’t be – the data you can find around that game’s sales performance will be much more insightful than data from <i>Hollow Knight</i> . One is simply more applicable to the kinds of players you plan to target.	即使你的游戏与《蔚蓝》并非如出一辙(当然也不应如此),但相比于《空洞骑士》的销售业绩数据,《蔚蓝》这方面的数据将更有意义。《蔚蓝》更适用于你的目标游戏受众。
Unfortunately, no data are perfect, and your analysis needs to account for what you don’t know and what you can’t know.	可惜没有完美无暇的数据,在分析时,需要考虑自己不了解以及无法了解的内容。
The Ins and Outs of Sales Data	销售数据的来龙去脉
Sales data for games is usually derived from the following sources: ●Steam Spy (SteamSpy.com) ●Press coverage (unit sales, if possible) ●Steam user reviews ●Earning reports (from publicly traded companies) ●Sales estimated by reviews ●Data from third party tools or consultants ●Your team’s past sales performance (if applicable)	游戏的销售数据通常来自以下渠道: ●Steam Spy (一款专门统计 Steam 游戏销量数据的网站) ●媒体报道 (如果可能的话关注游戏销量) ●Steam 用户评价 ●收入报表 (来自上市公司) ●通过评论估计销量 ●第三方工具或咨询公司 ●团队过往销售业绩 (如果适用的话)
For many years, Steam Spy was the industry standard for analyzing sales performance in the games industry. While Steam Spy is still operational today, the data it provides is very	多年以来, Steam Spy 一直是业内分析销售业绩的行业标准。虽然如今 Steam Spy 仍在运行,但提供的数据却有所不同。过去,它依靠 Steam API 权限,从平台提取出相对精

different. Steam Spy relied on access to the Steam API to extract relatively accurate performance data from the platform. When Valve stopped supporting this functionality, Steam Spy lost access to the data it needed.	准的业绩数据。在维尔福集团（Valve）不再支持这项功能后，Steam Spy 也就无法获取到所需的数据。
Steam Spy now uses a model rooted in machine learning, which uses publicly available data to infer conclusions for how many units a title may have sold. According to a 2018 article from Kotaku, Steam Spy creator Sergey Galyonkin believes the site has a 10 percent margin for error. That margin for error is likely to be more extreme for less popular titles because of limits on available data, so indies should be especially wary.	现在，Steam Spy 的运行模式基于机器学习，即利用公开数据来推论出游戏可能的销量。根据 Kotaku 网站 2018 年的一篇文章，Steam Spy 的创建人谢尔盖·加里奥金（Sergey Galyonkin）表示网站的推论存在 10% 的误差。对于受欢迎程度较低的游戏，由于其可获取的数据有限，销量推测的误差可能还会更大，所以独立游戏制作人应该格外谨慎。
To be clear, Steam Spy data were never 100 percent accurate for a variety of reasons, and that caused significant controversy for developers who were judged by Steam Spy data, but even some imperfect data is better than no data at all.	需要明确一点，由于各种原因，Steam Spy 的数据绝非 100% 准确，因此利用这项数据来评价开发者，会令其饱受争议，但即便数据存在缺陷，也好过没有数据。
For example, Steam Spy estimates that <i>Celeste</i> has 500,000–1,000,000 Steam owners, which is a pretty broad range. For most indies, a shift in sales by 1,000 units or more can be substantial, so we don't have enough data to go on yet.	例如，Steam Spy 估计《蔚蓝》的 Steam 用户为 50-100 万，受众相当广泛。对于多数独立游戏制作人而言，销量增加 1000 或以上，销售数额的变化十分可观，因而目前还没有充足的数据继续用于研究。
If we next dig for press coverage about <i>Celeste</i> sales, we can find a variety of articles reporting units sold to date. At the time of this writing, the most recent article about <i>Celeste</i> sales figures was	接下来，如果搜集媒体关于《蔚蓝》销售额的报道，会发现大量文章报道截至目前的销量。在撰写本文时，关于该游戏最新的销量数据来自 IGN 网站 2020 年 3 月的一篇文章，

a March 2020 article from <i>IGN</i> that reported <i>Celeste</i> total sales had passed 1,000,000 units.	报道称其总销量已逾 100 万。
Though the article is light on specifics, total units usually implies that those sales are across all available platforms, not just Steam, so we now have a better idea of how accurate Steam Spy's data was, but if we go digging even more, we can find some insights on how well <i>Celeste</i> did on the Nintendo Switch.	尽管这篇文章提及的具体数据不多,但是总销量通常意味着全网所有平台的总计销量,并非只包括 Steam 的销量,所以现在更能体会 Steam Spy 数据的准确度有限,但是如果继续搜集资料,就能发现《蔚蓝》在任天堂的 Switch 端上的销量表现。
Maddy Thorson, the co-creator <i>Celeste</i> who worked alongside Noel Berry, told <i>Destructoid</i> that "The Switch version of <i>Celeste</i> has sold the most, and that's what we were expecting. We feel like <i>Celeste</i> and the Switch are a perfect fit for each other."	马特·索尔森 (Maddy Thorson) 同诺尔·贝瑞 (Noel Berry) 合作开发了《蔚蓝》,她告诉 <i>Destructoid</i> 网站: "Switch 版《蔚蓝》销量最高,这在预料之中。我们认为《蔚蓝》与 Switch 端彼此完美契合。"
That's not hard data, but it does give us a big clue: If your game has something in common with <i>Celeste</i> and <i>Celeste</i> did exceptionally well on Switch in addition to its success on Steam, your development roadmap should likely include a Switch release as well.	这并非硬性数据,但这确实提供了一大思路:《蔚蓝》除了在 Steam 上大获成功,在 Switch 端的表现也不容小觑,如果你的游戏与《蔚蓝》有相同之处,那么开发路线图也应该包括发行 Switch 版游戏的计划。
We can further bolster this analysis by looking for other data sources. If your game is comparable to an AAA title in some way, you might be able to find public earnings reports that disclose total unit sales or gross profit from a particular title. This is relatively rare in the indie world because most developers and publishers in our corner of the industry are relatively small in comparison to	通过搜集其他渠道的数据,能够进一步支持这一分析。如果你的游戏从某些方面而言算得上是某款 3A 游戏的同类游戏,也许能在相关的公开收入报告中找到这款游戏的总销量或总利润。这在独立游戏行业非常罕见,因为较之 3A 游戏团队的规模,独立游戏的多数开发团队和发行商的规模相对较小,但现在已经出现了一种趋势:较大的母

AAA outfits, but there has been a trend of larger parent companies acquiring several indie studios at once.	公司会同时收购数个独立游戏工作室。
So, even though the possibilities are slim, you may find one of your comparable titles belongs to a company that regularly shares earning reports, but you won't know unless you look.	所以,即使可能性非常渺茫,仍有几率发现某个同类游戏属于定期发布收益报告的公司,但是除非你经过一番资料搜集,否则将无从得知这一点。
The last two data sources available to indies can be controversial. You can approximate unit sales based on the number of Steam reviews a game has received, and you can also use third-party tools to gain extra insights as well.	独立游戏制作人获取销售数据的最后两种渠道存在争议。可以根据游戏在 Steam 上的评论数量来估计销量,也能够使用第三方工具来获得额外数据。
Steam Spy is a third party tool. It is not officially affiliated with Valve, and it offers a variety of features available only to registered and paying users. Several such tools exist in the games industry, and we are hesitant to officially endorse any of them because the industry changes so rapidly that our recommendation for one tool over another could be outdated by the time you read this. Instead, we'll share that you should tread carefully with third-party tools. They can be incredibly powerful in many respects, but you should also be mindful of their cost (they are typically pricey) and their limitations (what they can actually do versus what they guess at).	Steam Spy 是一款第三方工具,并非维尔福集团官方附带工具,只给注册用户与付费用户提供海量功能。游戏业内像这样的工具还有好几个,但是由于游戏业日新月异,可能到读者阅读此书时,推荐的工具早已过时,所以本书将不对任何工具作出推荐。相反,此处强调的是读者需谨慎使用第三方工具。虽然这些工具有着诸多强大的功能,但也应该注意它们的成本(通常昂贵)与局限性(实际功能对预估功能)。
That disclaimer aside, estimating game sales based on Steam reviews is a common practice in the industry, but like Steam Spy, you can't	撇开免责声明不谈,根据 Steam 评论数估计游戏销量是业内常见做法,但像 Steam Spy 一样,得出的结论并非 100%准确无误。这

completely trust that the conclusion you reach is accurate. It's a hint, another reference point that helps you triangulate roughly how successful a game was.	种做法只是一个提示、另一种参考，有助于大致判断游戏的成功程度。
The best math for this estimate comes from Simon Carless, the author behind <i>The Game Discoverability Now!</i> newsletter. In 2020, he polled his readers and used sales data from 237 games to correlate the quantity of public Steam reviews to actual sales. He found that, on average, a game sold 63 units per review.	西蒙·卡利斯（Simon Carless）是游戏业数据分析公司 Game DiscoverCo 的联合创始人，也是时事通讯《现在的游戏可发现性！》（ <i>The Game Discoverability Now!</i> ）的作者，他为上述预估销量的方式带来了最佳数学思路。2020 年，通过读者投票与 237 款游戏的销量数据，确定了 Steam 公开评论数量与实际销量之间的关系，发现平均每条评论对应 63 份销量。
Carless also notes other key points for consideration: ●The “middle 80 percent of the sample” ranged from 25 to 100 units sold per review ●Compared to survey data published in 2018 by Jake Birkett, average units sold per review is trending downward (Birkett found 82 sales per review in his research) ●Games launched in 2020 averaged 41 units sold per review ●This average is likely to continue trending downward as Steam makes bigger efforts to collect more reviews more often ●The line from total units sold to estimating total profit is not a straight one	卡利斯也指出其他需要考虑的关键之处： ●抽样中排在中间 80% 的游戏，每条评论对应的销量范围为 25-100 份 ●相比于杰克·伯其特（Jake Birkett）2018 年发布的调研数据，每条评论对应的平均销量有所下滑（伯其特在研究中发现每条评论对应 82 份销量） ●发行于 2020 年的游戏，平均每条评论对应 41 份销量 ●随着 Steam 更频繁努力地收集更多评论，这个平均值可能还会持续下跌 ●总销量与预估总利润并不对等

For that last point, Carless says, “You’ve got to factor in average ‘regular’ price on Steam, how much and how often the game was on sale, and then after the money comes in, Steam platform cut, refunds, and VAT before you even get close to working out the real number. (Realistically, that’s 30%–50% of the ‘optimistic’ gross number, and potentially way less, if discounting is aggressive.)”	对于最后一点，卡利斯表示：“必须考虑到 Steam 上‘常规’价格的均值、游戏促销的频率及程度，以及玩家付款到账之后，要扣除 Steam 平台费、玩家退款、缴纳的增值税，之后得到的数字才接近实际销售额。（实际上，这是‘乐观’总量的 30%-50%，如果打折力度增大，这个数字可能会更小。）”
To add to this point about revenue being a fuzzy number, don’t forget that we’re mainly discussing Steam numbers here as it’s impossible to find sales numbers for console versions of a game unless a developer discloses them.	上述内容是为了补充说明收入是个模糊的数字，但是别忘了这里主要讨论的是 Steam 的数据，因为除非开发者公布游戏端机版本的销量数据，否则无从找到对应的数据。
Additionally, we have already explored how the revenue potential for a game isn’t purely contained in raw sales figures. <i>Celeste</i> has been incredibly successful with merchandise, and we also know from the Epic Games report on minimum guarantees that <i>Celeste</i> earned \$750,000 from the Epic Games Store alone.	此外，已经探讨过游戏收益潜力不只包含在原始销售数据中的方式。《蔚蓝》的游戏周边产品极为畅销，我们还从 Epic Games 的最低分成报告了解到，仅在这一家平台商店，《蔚蓝》就赚了 75 万美元。
Though Carless is transparent about the limitations of this approach, the exact math to use here is hotly debated amongst industry experts. Some publishers still use this approach to guess at a game’s total sales while other publishers have seen such radical variability in their own ratio of reviews to sales that they are hesitant to trust any mystical industry average.	尽管卡利斯对这种估算的局限性十分清楚，但使用该方法预估游戏销量的精准程度，引起了业内专家的热议。一些发行商仍然利用这种方式来预测游戏的总销量，而其他发行商已经通过个人的游戏评论与销售之比意识到了这种估算的误差很大，再不敢信任任何来源不明的行业均值。

If we apply the 63 units per review estimate to <i>Celeste</i>, we would conclude that the game sold 2,153,781 units on Steam (based on 34,181 reviews at the time of this writing). Based on the news reports we highlighted earlier, that number feels too large, though it may be possible that the game saw a surge of popularity in 2020 and 2021.	如果以每条评论对应 63 份销量,来估算《蔚蓝》的销量,可以得出以下结论:该游戏在 Steam 上销售了 2153781 份(基于截至写书时的 34181 条评论数)。根据此前强调的新闻报道,即使该游戏可能在 2020 至 2021 年间人气激增,这一数据仍然过高。
If you use the least optimistic total in Carless' range, which was 25 units per review, the number fits much better: 854,525 units sold.	如果使用卡利斯范围中的“最不乐观总量”,即每条评论对应 25 份销量,那么估算的数字更符合实际:854525 份销量。
What do you actually do with this data, especially since much of it is an educated guess, at best?	事实上,如何最大程度利用这些数据,尤其在大部分数据只是有根据的猜测时?
Here's our recommendation: ●Analyze several comparable titles for your game and try to capture reference points for a reasonable success in the genre (and not just the mega outliers, like <i>Celeste</i>) ●In bullet form, perhaps on PowerPoint slides, summarize what you could find for sales and platform performance, note their undiscounted list prices, and also note their Metacritic score and their total steam reviews ●Identify what your game has in common with these titles and what's different (such as art style, game length, theme, and so on) ●Based on the data you collected, make a tentative estimate of how many units a mildly successful title in this genre might move	建议如下: ●分析几个同类游戏,尝试找到同类型游戏可供参考的成功经验(不只局限在《蔚蓝》这样火出圈的游戏) ●用分点列项式(可以利用幻灯片)总结找到的销量与平台绩效的内容,注明无折扣标价、Metacritic 分数及 Steam 总评论数 ●确定游戏与同类游戏之间的异同(比如美术风格、游戏时长、主题等) ●基于收集的数据,尝试估计稍微成功的同类游戏型可能的销量
Emphasis on “mildly successful.” We all want	要强调的是“稍微成功”。我们当然希望你

your next game to be an iconic indie success story, selling millions of units like <i>Celeste</i>, but a sustainable business plan grounds itself in practical realities. If your game is good, if your marketing is good, what is a safe sales projection? What is a pessimistic sales projection?	的下一款游戏成为独立游戏经典之作，像《蔚蓝》一样销量逾百万，但可持续的商业方案需要立足于现实。如果游戏精良，市场营销到位，则保守的销售预期是多少？悲观的销售预期又是多少？
This exercise will prepare you to talk to investors and publishers about the potential impact of your game, but long before that, you can use those projections to vet your estimated budget. This estimate is easier to make if you have released games before, so if you have a past game to base potential future performance on, factor that in also.	这种练习将有助于更好地向投资者与发行商介绍游戏的潜在影响力，但是在此之前，可以利用销量预测来审查预估的预算。如果此前有游戏发行的经验，做这种估算愈发简单，所以假如过往游戏能作为未来潜在绩效的参考，也需要纳入考虑。
If your development budget exceeds what you can safely estimate for total net profit, you have a problem. The scope of your game could be too large for the market. Your development resources might be too expensive or poorly allocated. Your target genre could be too narrow. Your timeline could be too long.	如果开发预算超过了保守净利润总量的估值，说明规划存在问题，包括游戏范围对于市场而言可能太大了、开发资源可能过于昂贵或者分配不当、目标类型可能太过局限、时间线可能过长等。
The source of the problem will vary, but looking at the numbers early on will help to keep these problems from morphing into catastrophes later.	造成问题的根源可能有所不同，但尽早注意到数据存在问题，能够避免上述问题发展成灾难性错误。
Trends and Traps	趋势与误区
In addition to sales data, your market research should aim to capture the direction of a genre as well. This analysis is even less scientific than estimating sales data from Steam reviews, but	除了销售数据，市场调查也应该注重把握某类游戏类型的发展趋势。这种分析的科学性甚至不如以 Steam 评论数估算销量，但了解这些趋势至关重要。游戏需要达到一种奇妙

your diligence matters. Your game needs to strike the strange balance of feeling familiar to longtime fans of a genre while at the same time offering a new and memorable experience. To do that, you need a deep understanding of what has happened in the genre and insights into where the genre might go.	的平衡，既让某类游戏的老玩家感到熟悉，同时又要为之提供全新且难忘的游戏体验。为此，就需要深入了解这类游戏的发展历程并对之后可能的发展趋势有独到的见解。
With the benefit of hindsight, we can see that a game such as <i>Celeste</i> tapped into several industry trends while also offering a fantastic gameplay experience. Retro pixel art has long been an indie staple, but <i>Celeste</i> carefully builds mood and setting with its art direction, level design, and polish. <i>Shovel Knight</i> found success here as well, but the platforming of <i>Celeste</i> is probably more akin to the <i>Super Meatboy</i> experience: move fast, avoid the spikes, die a lot, and keep trying.	凭借后见之明的优势，我们能发现《蔚蓝》之类的游戏在利用多个行业趋势的同时，还提供了妙不可言的游戏玩法体验。复古像素画风一直是独立游戏的主打元素，但是《蔚蓝》通过美术设计、关卡设计以及精心优化营造了氛围与设定。《铲子骑士》(<i>Shovel Knight</i>)在这方面也很成功，但《蔚蓝》的平台化经历可能与《超级食肉男孩》更为类似：发展迅速，错开峰值，失败多次，且不断尝试。
The tone of <i>Celeste</i> , a deeply emotional narrative of self-discovery, fits into the broad trend of emotional indie storytelling. <i>Gone Home</i> , though very different in terms of gameplay, taps into this trend, as do games like <i>Braid</i> , <i>Bastion</i> , and <i>Undertale</i> .	《蔚蓝》是一款情感叙事类游戏，剧情关于主角深刻的自我救赎，这种风格顺应了独立游戏情感故事的大趋势。尽管《到家》的游戏玩法截然不同，但也利用了这一趋势，《时空幻境》(<i>Braid</i>)、《堡垒》(<i>Bastion</i>)和《传说之下》也是如此。
The platformers that would follow <i>Celeste</i> , titles like <i>Katana Zero</i> and <i>Blasphemous</i> , build on these hallmarks in their own way, pushing the idea of storytelling in a pixel art indie platformer to new and interesting places in 2019, which were then followed by titles like <i>Ori and the Will of the</i>	2019年继《蔚蓝》之后，《武士刀零》(<i>Katana Zero</i>)和《神之亵渎》(<i>Blasphemous</i>)等平台游戏也用自己的方式构建了这些标志，将像素风独立平台游戏的故事理念推动到全新而有趣的高度。2020年，《奥日与萤火意志》(<i>Ori and the Will of the Wisps</i>)和《洞窟

<i>Wisps</i> and <i>Spelunky 2</i> in 2020.	探险 2》(<i>Spelunky 2</i>) 等游戏紧随其后。
We should note, however, that <i>Celeste</i> had a few other key advantages contributing to its success.	然而，我们也应该注意到《蔚蓝》的成功，还源于一些其他核心优势。
Thorson had previously made <i>Towerfall</i> and also created several popular levels in <i>Super Mario Maker</i> , and the fingerprints of the latter seem to be clearly visible in <i>Celeste</i> . Noel Berry, co-creator of <i>Celeste</i> , worked on a game called <i>Skytorn</i> . Though it had garnered some early interest from players, <i>Skytorn</i> was ultimately cancelled not long after the release of <i>Celeste</i> .	此前，索尔森制作过《塔倒：升天》(<i>Towerfall</i>)，也在《超级马里奥制造》(<i>Super Mario Maker</i>)中设计过数个大受欢迎的关卡，在《蔚蓝》中似乎还能清晰地看到后者的痕迹。《蔚蓝》的另一位制作者诺尔·贝瑞，曾参与《撕裂天空》(<i>Skytorn</i>)项目。尽管项目初期引起了玩家的兴趣，但在《蔚蓝》发行后不久，这个项目最终还是取消了。
<i>Celeste</i> itself was born from a four-day game jam project and was first released as a PICO-8 game. Since we are talking about how to predict the potential success of a game, we should highlight the similarities in the <i>Celeste</i> development story to other stories we've shared in the book. <i>Super Meatboy</i> began as a much shorter Flash game, and <i>Turnip Boy Commits Tax Evasion</i> started as a quick game jam project.	《蔚蓝》的雏形是一款为期 4 天的限时游戏开发活动中的项目，最初作为 PICO-8 游戏发行。因为此处是在讨论预测游戏成功潜力的方式，所以应该强调《蔚蓝》和本书中的其他游戏在开发过程中的相同点。《超级食肉男孩》的雏形是一款短小的 Flash 游戏，《大头菜小子偷税记》则是限时游戏开发活动的项目。
So, in addition to broader market signals about what players wanted from an indie platformer, <i>Celeste</i> also had the benefit of confirming traction in its core ideas through lessons learned from Thorson's and Berry's previous games, Thorson's <i>Super Mario Maker</i> levels, and the PICO-8 incarnation of <i>Celeste</i> .	所以，《蔚蓝》除了掌握到更广泛的市场信号，有关玩家所期待的独立平台游戏外，还有一大优势，即利用索尔森和贝瑞过往游戏中学到的经验（索尔森设计的《超级马里奥制造》关卡和《蔚蓝》的前身 PICO-8 游戏），确认了核心创意的市场欢迎度。
We are going to such great lengths to tell this	之所以详细阐述《蔚蓝》的经历，是想说明

story because it is important to understand that a game like <i>Celeste</i> does not materialize from pure inspiration. Rather, we would argue that <i>Celeste</i> is a masterful culmination of the developers' multitude of industry experiences mixed with an artful insight into what would be an original and engaging design for players.	诸如此类的游戏并非仅靠灵感而成，读者明白这一点至关重要。相反，《蔚蓝》是匠心集成之作：融合了开发者丰富的业内经验与精妙洞察力，知道如何开发吸引玩家的原创设计。
In other words, Thorson and Berry combined two types of data: industry trends and personal experience. We can't explicitly say how exactly that played out behind the scenes and how much of those choices were conscious versus unconscious, but the power of the outcome is clear.	换句话说，索尔森和贝瑞结合了两类数据：行业趋势和个人经验。我们无法清楚言明这些是如何起作用的、哪些是有意为之、哪些是无意之举，但结果却非常清楚。
If you base your development purely on broad industry trends, you are likely to fall into three traps: ●Your game will feel like a less interesting version of more successful titles ●Your game will make a big bet on a trend that could die out before you can even launch ●Your game may not stand out when there are hundreds of similar titles trying to take advantage of the trend	如果开发完全基于广泛的行业趋势，可能会陷入以下三个误区： ●游戏像某个热门游戏的低配版 ●游戏将在趋势上孤注一掷，而这个趋势可能在游戏发行之前就已然消失 ●数百个类似游戏都试图利用这一趋势时，游戏可能无法脱颖而出
Even today, well after the surprise success of <i>Among Us</i>, social deduction games of all varieties are launching on Steam each day. Though its initial success was several years ago, we are also still seeing the ripples of <i>PUBG</i>'s battle royale	即使是现在，《在我们之间》意外爆火之后，每天仍有各种社交推理游戏陆续登陆 Steam。尽管《绝地求生》（<i>PUBG</i>）一炮而红发生在几年前，但现在仍能看到吃鸡游戏的成功所带来的涟漪效应。很多独立游戏制

success, with many indies trying to put their own twist on the battle royale format or outright cloning existing battle royale games.	作人都试图将自己的游戏创意套在吃鸡游戏模式上或直接复刻已有的吃鸡游戏。
From a publisher's perspective, we expect to hear hundreds of pitches in the vein of recently popular games to the point that it can feel like a bad joke (<i>Hades</i> anyone?). From the developer's perspective – and we've sat on that side of the table as well – the advice to not look at the latest hits as market indicators could seem contradictory to our previous advice, which was to find comparable titles to benchmark the potential success of your game.	如果说发行商期待听到数百个模仿近期热门游戏的推介方案，这宛如一个冷笑话（难道没人想过模仿《哈迪斯》？）。开发者（我们也制作游戏）不应该将最新的热门游戏当作市场指标，这似乎跟之前的建议自相矛盾，即找到同类游戏来衡量游戏成功的潜力。
And you'd be right. There is a potential contradiction buried between those lines, but the real point is to strike a careful balance. If you made a quaint farm management game with colorful pixel art and a variety of NPC relationships to explore, both players and publishers alike could feel as if this was simply another version of <i>Stardew Valley</i> . If instead you took inspiration from those mechanics but reimagined the theme, such as managing a medieval cemetery instead of managing a farm, the conversation you have about your game can talk about why the millions of people who bought <i>Stardew Valley</i> would also be interested in your game.	会感到疑惑合情合理，因为这两个建议之间确实暗藏矛盾，而关键在于达到微妙的平衡。如果开发了一款精巧的像素风农场管理游戏，色彩丰富的美术风格、各个 NPC 之间的关系可供玩家探索，那么玩家与发行商可能都会觉得这只是《星露谷物语》（ <i>Stardew Valley</i> ）的翻版。相反，如果从这些机制中获得灵感，却重新设想主题，如管理中世纪墓地而非农场，那么介绍游戏时可以解释为什么数以百万计的《星露谷物语》玩家可能也对这款游戏感兴趣。
You might know the game we're talking about:	你可能已经猜到了上述游戏：由 Lazy Bear

<i>Graveyard Keeper</i> , developed by Lazy Bear Games and published by tinyBuild.	游戏公司开发、tinyBuild 发行的《守墓人》(<i>Graveyard Keeper</i>)。
<i>Graveyard Keeper</i> has a great deal in common with <i>Stardew Valley</i> , but what it has in common with other comparable titles is only one piece of the story. Lazy Bear Games took many deliberate steps to make their game fit into the genre while also making it stand out.	《守墓人》同《星露谷物语》的相似之处众多，但与其他同类游戏相比，仅部分剧情类似。《守墓人》能在这类游戏中脱颖而出，得益于 Lazy Bear 游戏公司诸多深思熟虑之举。
If the pitch for <i>Graveyard Keeper</i> boiled down to “ <i>Stardew Valley</i> was successful, so our game will be successful,” which is often how a pitch for a social deduction game sounds in a post- <i>Among Us</i> market, it likely would not have found a home with tinyBuild. Instead, one can imagine (and this is all speculation on our part), that the pitch for <i>Graveyard Keeper</i> touched on a variety of comparable titles while also leaning into its whacky premise.	如果《守墓人》推介的重点放在“因为《星露谷物语》很成功，所以这款游戏也将会成功”(在《在我们之间》成功发行后，这类说辞常见于社交推理游戏的推介中)，那么 tinyBuild 可能不会发行这款游戏。相反，可以想象(这部分完全基于猜测)，虽然《守墓人》的推介中提及多款同类游戏，但其荒诞离奇而又妙趣横生的游戏设定却是其最大的底气。
We will talk more about positioning your game in a pitch in Part 3: Pitch Deck Perfection, but for your early planning, be critical of your own originality. Players who love a game like <i>Stardew Valley</i> are often not looking for a slightly better version of <i>Stardew Valley</i> (if such a thing could exist). Instead, they are likely looking for games that build on one or several of the ideas that made <i>Stardew Valley</i> engaging, taking those mechanics and concepts to very new places.	第三部分：完善推介文档将讨论在推介方案中如何定位游戏，但对于前期规划而言，要批判地看待原创。通常喜欢《星露谷物语》这类游戏的玩家不期待找到优于它的游戏(如果真的存在这样的游戏)。相反，他们可能感兴趣的是，那些跟《星露谷物语》有相似特质、且将类似机制与概念发展到新高度的游戏。
Stepping Back for the Big Picture	回顾大局

If you conduct a thorough genre and market evaluation for your project, you will generate pages of notes and several rows of data. Once you feel like you have fully explored the market, review your notes, organize them, and start to summarize conclusions. The goals for this stage are four-fold: ●Solidify your broad understanding of and familiarity with your target genre ●Build the case for why players would buy your game ●Establish preliminary sales projections for your game ●Critically challenge your own assumptions about your game's potential	如果为项目类型及市场做了详尽的评估,那么你所收获的内容能够汇总成数页笔记、数行数据。一旦你认为市场调研已经足够充分,就可以对笔记进行回顾、加以整理后得出结论。本阶段的目标分为以下四个方面: ●强化对于目标类型的理解及熟悉度 ●阐述玩家会购买游戏的原因 ●为游戏设定初步销售预期 ●批判性质疑游戏潜力的假设
Long before you pitch to an investor or to a publisher, you have to convince yourself that your game has financial potential. Convincing yourself that your project would be intrinsically rewarding to make or that you personally would enjoy playing the game you envision is easy. Building the business case is hard.	在向投资人或发行商推介之前,必须先说服自己认可游戏具有经济潜力。轻而易举就能说服自己相信制作这个项目能带来收益,或自己构思的这款游戏可玩度很高,但说服他人投资却很难。
The mental exercise here is to step out of your passionate indie dev shoes and to step into the shoes of an objective investor. Can you convince a person that your project has merit using industry data and industry analysis? They don't know you. They don't see the full vision for your game as you do. But they have a budget they are willing to	这里的思维练习有助于读者从激情澎湃的独立游戏制作人的角度跳出来,设身处地以目标投资人的角度来思考问题。是否能够通过行业数据与行业分析来说服别人相信游戏具有优势?他们并不了解你,也不像你那样了解完整版游戏的情况,但他们有为游戏预算投资的意愿。

invest.	
You may get this right on the first try, but like all of the planning elements have discussed so far, this process is more likely to be a fluid activity that you come back to throughout your project. In the next chapters, we are going to dig deeper into building the development plan for your project—everything from choosing an art style to creating a budget spreadsheet—and a new choice or insight in those areas could influence your market analysis.	可能你在第一次尝试时就做到了这一点,但同目前为止讨论过的所有规划环节一样,这个过程更类似于整个项目过程中需要不断回顾的动态活动。下一章将进一步讨论项目开发方案的制定,包括美术风格选择、预算电子表创建等,这些内容中的新选择或新看法都能影响市场分析。
That is normal, and in many respects, it is supposed to happen that way. Even if your project does not change significantly in the rest of your planning process, you should still revisit this analysis with the more detailed vision of your plan in hand to reconfirm your initial market analysis conclusions.	不断回顾之举实属正常,从很多方面而言也应当如此。即使规划过程的其余部分并未作出大刀阔斧的调整,你仍然应该利用目前更为细致的方案重新审视此前的相关分析,从而重新确认初始的市场分析结论。